סֵפֶר פְּרִי צַדִּיק

PRI TZADDIK

Opening and the Shabbos Treatises

Opening · Kedushas Shabbos · Shevisas Shabbos

Interlinear Translation with Annotated Footnotes

Akiva Publishing · 2026

Pri Tzaddik

Interlinear Translation with Annotated Footnotes · Opening · Kedushas Shabbos · Shevisas Shabbos

This volume presents the original title text, the publishers' introduction, Kedushas Shabbos, ois 1–7, and Shevisas Shabbos, ois 1–7. The historical opening material is retained in Hebrew with its English translation.

The Hebrew text of the author is presented with vocalization, followed phrase by phrase by its English translation in bold. Source quotations and parallel passages appear in numbered footnotes. Every maamar has a descriptive title, and the contents lists its subsections. Editorial headings are distinct from the words of the original work.

Methodological note: This edition was prepared with the assistance of AI tools for drafting, translation, source organization, and formatting. The original Hebrew remains the controlling text for study. References to Akiva Publishing editions use their own paragraph divisions, which may differ from those of other editions.

Original work פרי צדיק by Rabbi Tzadok HaKohen Rabinowitz of Lublin (1823–1900).

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Original Title Page

סֵפֶר פְּרִי צַדִּיק — **The Book "Peri Tzaddik" (Fruit of the Righteous)**

עַל הַתּוֹרָה וְרֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ וַחֲנֻכָּה. — **On the Torah, Rosh Chodesh, and Chanukah.**

הֵן הֵנָּה אֲמָרוֹת קְדוֹשׁוֹת וּטְהוֹרוֹת שֶׁיָּצְאוּ מִפֶּה קָדוֹשׁ, — **These are holy and pure utterances that emerged from a holy mouth,** פּוּם מְמַלֵּל רַבְרְבִין,[1] — **an Aramaic idiom: "a mouth speaking great things" (Daniel 7:8; Zohar),** מִדֵּי חֹדֶשׁ בְּחָדְשׁוֹ וּמִדֵּי שַׁבָּת בְּשַׁבַּתּוֹ,[2] — **from New Moon to New Moon, and from Sabbath to Sabbath (Isaiah 66:23),** וְנִסְפַּח בְּתוֹכוֹ — **and appended within it are**

סֵפֶר קְדֻשַּׁת שַׁבָּת וְקִוּנְטְרֵס שְׁבִיתַת שַׁבָּת, — **the Book "Kedushat Shabbat" (The Sanctity of Shabbat) and the Treatise "Shevitat Shabbat" (The Rest of Shabbat),**

וּבְסוֹפוֹ קִצּוּר קִוּנְטְרֵס עֵת הָאֹכֶל — **and at its conclusion, an abridgment of the Treatise "Et HaOkhel" (The Time of Eating),** שֶׁהַמָּה כְּתוּבִים בְּעָצֶם כְּתַב יַד קָדְשׁוֹ — **which were written in his very own holy handwriting,**

מֵאֵת פְּבוֹד קְדֻשַּׁת אֲדוֹנֵנוּ מוֹרֵנוּ וְרַבֵּנוּ הַגָּאוֹן הַקָּדוֹשׁ, — **from the presence of the holiness of our master, teacher, and rabbi, the holy Gaon,** שַׁר הַתּוֹרָה, כְּחַד מִקַּמָּאֵי, — **minister of the Torah, like one of the early Rishonim,** דָּמֵי לְבַר אֱלָהִין,[3] — **resembling a divine angel (Daniel 3:25),** עֲטֶרֶת תִּפְאֶרֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל, — **crown of the glory of Israel,** לוֹ דֻמִיָּה תְהִלָּה,[4] — **unto whom silence is praise (Psalms 65:2),**

רַבֵּנוּ צָדוֹק הַכֹּהֵן זֵכֶר צַדִּיק וְקָדוֹשׁ לִבְרָכָה לְחַיֵּי הָעוֹלָם הַבָּא מִלּוּבְלִין הֲרֵינִי כַּפָּרַת מִשְׁכָּבוֹ, — **our master Tzadok HaKohen, may the memory of the righteous and holy be for a blessing for the life of the World to Come, of Lublin, may I be an atonement for his resting place,**

בֶּן הָרַב הַגָּאוֹן הֶחָסִיד וְכוּ' רַבִּי יַעֲקֹב הַכֹּהֵן זְכוּרוֹנוֹ לִבְרָכָה אַב בֵּית דִּין דִּקְהִלָּה קְדוֹשָׁה קְרִיזְבּוּרְג. — **son of the Gaon and Chassid, etc., Rabbi Yaakov HaKohen, of blessed memory, Av Beit Din of the holy community of Kreuzburg.**

זְכוּת קְדֻשַּׁת תּוֹרָתוֹ וְצִדְקָתוֹ יָגֵן עָלֵינוּ וְעַל כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל, אָמֵן: — **May the merit of the holiness of his Torah and his righteousness protect us and all Israel, Amen:**

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[1] **Daniel 7:8**: 'I considered the horns, and behold, there came up among them another little horn, before which three of the first horns were plucked up by the roots; and behold, in this horn were eyes like the eyes of a man, and a mouth speaking great things (u-fum memallel ravrevan).'

[2] **Isaiah 66:23**: 'And new moon after new moon, And sabbath after sabbath, All flesh shall come to worship Me —said GOD.'

[3] **Daniel 3:25**: 'He answered and said: 'Behold, I see four men loose, walking in the midst of the fire, and they have no hurt; and the appearance of the fourth is like a son of the gods (bar elahin)—a divine angel.''

[4] **Psalms 65:2**: 'Unto You, O God, silence is praise (lekha dumiyah tehillah) in Zion; and unto You shall the vow be performed.'

Publishers Introduction

כָּךְ פָּתַח רַבִּי תַּנְחוּמָא בַּר אִיתָא בַּתַּנְחוּמָא (פָּרָשַׁת נֹחַ)[5] — **It is stated in Midrash Tanchuma (Parashat Noach 2):** "פְּרִי צַדִּיק עֵץ חַיִּים וְלֹקֵחַ נְפָשׁוֹת חָכָם" (מִשְׁלֵי י״א:ל׳)[6]. — **"'The fruit of the righteous is a tree of life, and he that is wise wins souls' (Proverbs 11:30)."** וְאָמַר אַבָּא — **Thus did Rabbi Tanchuma bar Abba open his discourse and state:** אָמַר רַבִּי יְהוּדָה הַלֵּוִי: — **Rabbi Yehudah HaLevi said:** בְּשָׁעָה שֶׁהָאָדָם מִסְתַּלֵּק מִן הָעוֹלָם בְּלֹא בָנִים הוּא מִצַּר וּבוֹכֶה. — **At the hour when a person departs from the world without children, he grieves and weeps.** אָמַר לוֹ הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא: — **The Holy One, blessed be He, says to him:** לָמָּה אַתָּה בוֹכֶה? — **Why are you weeping?** מִפְּנֵי שֶׁלֹּא הֶעֱמַדְתָּ פְּרִי בָעוֹלָם הַזֶּה? — **Is it because you did not establish fruit in this world?** אָמַר לְפָנָיו: רִבּוֹנוֹ שֶׁל עוֹלָם, אֵיזֶה פְּרִי עָשָׂה שֶׁהֶעֱמַדְתִּי? — **He said before Him: Master of the Universe, what fruit is it that I have established?** אָמַר לוֹ הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא: הַתּוֹרָה, שֶׁכָּתוּב בָּהּ: "פְּרִי צַדִּיק עֵץ חַיִּים" – "בָּנִים" אֵינוֹ אוֹמֵר, אֶלָּא "פְּרִי צַדִּיק", עַד כָּאן לְשׁוֹנוֹ. — **The Holy One, blessed be He, said to him: The Torah, concerning which it is written: 'The fruit of the righteous is a tree of life'— it does not say 'children,' but rather 'the fruit of the righteous'; until here is its language.** יֵשׁ לְךָ פְּרִי יָפֶה מִן הַבָּנִים! — **Behold, you possess a fruit more beautiful than sons!**

וְכֵן מָרָן אָדוֹנֵנוּ מוֹרֵנוּ וְרַבֵּנוּ גְּאוֹן הַגְּאוֹנִים קָדֵשׁ הַקְּדָשִׁים רַבֵּנוּ הָרַב הַמְּחֻבָּר זָכָר צַדִּיק וְקָדוֹשׁ לְבָרָכָה לְחַיֵּי הָעוֹלָם הַבָּא, — **And likewise our master, our teacher, and our rabbi, the Gaon of Gaons, the Holy of Holies, our master the author, may the memory of the righteous and holy be for a blessing for the life of the World to Come,**

אֲשֶׁר עָלָה הַשָּׁמַיְמָה לֵאוֹר בְּאוֹר הַחַיִּים יוֹם שֵׁנִי ט' אֱלוּל שְׁנַת "צַדִּיק כַּתָּמָר יִפְרָח" (תר"ס), — **who ascended Heavenward to shine in the light of the living on Monday, the 9th of Elul, in the year 'The righteous shall flourish like a palm tree' 5660 / September 3, 1900,** וְהִנִּיחַ אַחֲרָיו בְּרָכָה כַּמָּה וְכַמָּה מֵאוֹת נְיָרוֹת כְּתוּבִים בְּכִתַב יַד קָדְשׁוֹ — **and left behind him a blessing: several hundred manuscripts written in his very own holy handwriting** בַּהֲלָכוֹת קְבוּעוֹת, שְׁאֵלוֹת וּתְשׁוּבוֹת, וְחִדּוּשֵׁי בַּבְלִי וִירוּשַׁלְמִי וְרַמְבַּ"ם, וּשְׁאֵלוֹת וּתְשׁוּבוֹת, וּכְלָלִים, — **in established Halakhah, Responsa, novellae on the Babylonian Talmud, Jerusalem Talmud, and Rambam, Responsa, and talmudic hermeneutical principles,** וְגַם הַרְבֵּה קוּנְטְרֵסִים קַטַנֵּי הַכַּמּוּת וְרַבֵּי הָאֵיכוּת, — **as well as numerous treatises concise in physical quantity yet vast in spiritual quality,** בְּטַעֲמֵי תּוֹרָה, דְּבָרִים שֶׁכִּסָּה עַתִּיק יוֹמִין[7], דְּבָרִים עֲמוּקִים הָעוֹמְדִים בְּרוּמוֹ שֶׁל עוֹלָם. — **in the esoteric inner reasons of the Torah, matters that the Ancient of Days concealed (Pesachim 119a), profound concepts standing at the pinnacle of the cosmos.**

וְתִהְלָּה לָאֵל שֶׁזָּכִינוּ בָּזֶה לְהוֹצִיא בָּרִאשׁוֹנָה לָאוֹר חֵלֶק זֶה — **And praise be to God that we have merited to bring forth to light for the first time this volume,** לְהָאִיר פְּנֵי תֵּבֵל בְּמָאוֹר תּוֹרָתוֹ דִּבְרֵי אֱלֹהִים חַיִּים, — **to illuminate the face of the earth with the radiance of his Torah, words of the living God,** אֲשֶׁר הִזִּיל כַּטַּל אִמְרָתוֹ מִדֵּי שַׁבָּת בְּשַׁבָּתוֹ וּמִדֵּי חֹדֶשׁ בְּחָדְשׁוֹ — **which dripped like dew in his spoken words from Sabbath to Sabbath and from New Moon to New Moon,** לְהַכְנִיס וְלִשְׁתֹּל בְּלִבְבוֹת יִשְׂרָאֵל אַהֲבַת תּוֹרָה וְיִרְאַת ה' וַעֲבוֹדָתוֹ. — **to instill and plant within the hearts of Israel love of Torah and the fear of Hashem and His service.** וְסִפַּחְנוּ בְּרֹאשׁוֹ סֵפֶר קְדֻשַּׁת שַׁבָּת וְקוּנְטְרֵס שְׁבִיתַת שַׁבָּת אֲשֶׁר כָּתָבָם בְּעֶצֶם כְּתַב יַד קָדְשׁוֹ. — **And we have appended at its beginning the book "Kedushat Shabbat" and the treatise "Shevitat Shabbat," which he wrote in his very own holy handwriting.** וְהִנֵּנוּ מִתְפַּלְּלִים עַל לְהַבָּא שֶׁהַמָּקוֹם יְהֵא בְּעֶזְרֵנוּ בִּזְכוּת קְדֻשַּׁת תּוֹרָתוֹ וְצִדְקָתוֹ, — **And we offer prayer for the future that the Omnipresent assist us in the merit of the holiness of his Torah and his**

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[5] **Midrash Tanchuma, Noach 2:1**: "These are the generations of Noah (Gen. 6:9). R. Tanhuma the son of Abba began the discussion of this subject with the verse: The fruit of the righteous is a tree of life; and he that is wise winneth souls (Prov. 11:30). R. Judah the Levite said: Whenever a man dies childless, he grieves and weeps. Thereupon the Holy One, blessed be He, consoles him with the words: "Wherefore do you weep over having left no fruit in this world? You have left fruit that is more desirable than children." "Sovereign of the universe," the man asks, "what fruit did I produce?" The Holy One, blessed be He, replies: "The Torah (you observed), concerning which it is written: the fruit of the righteous is a tree of life." The verse does not say that children are a tree of life but that the fruit of the righteous is a tree of life. Accordingly, man's most desirable offspring are his good works. Hence, it is written: These are the offspring of Noah. Noah was in his generations a man righteous and whole-hearted (Gen. 6:9)."

[6] **Proverbs 11:30**: 'The fruit of the righteous is a tree of life; The wise captivate people.'

[7] **Pesachim 119a:2**: "What is meant by "for an ancient covering"? This is one who conceals matters that the Ancient of Days concealed. And what are they? The mysteries of the Torah. Some say: This is one who reveals matters that the Ancient of Days concealed. What are they? The reasons of the Torah."

righteousness, שֶׁנִּזְכֶּה לְהוֹצִיא לָאוֹר גַּם שְׁאָר הַחֲלָקִים עַל כָּל הַתּוֹרָה וּמוֹעֲדִים וּשְׁאָר חִבּוּרָיו הַקְּדוֹשִׁים, **— that we may merit to publish also the remaining volumes on the entire Torah and festivals and his other holy compositions,** וּזְכוּתוֹ יָגֵן לְטוֹבָה עַל כָּל אֲשֶׁר יָהֶגוּ בַּסֵּפֶר הַזֶּה וְעַל כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל: **— and may his merit shield for good all who meditate upon this book and all Israel:**

הַמְּבִיאִים לְבֵית הַדְּפוּס **— The Publishers (HaMeivi'im L'veit HaDefus):**

Kedushas Shabbos Ois 1

Weekday Service and the Sanctity of Shabbat

בְּסַיְעָתָא דִּשְׁמַיָּא קוּנְטְרֵס קָרָאתִיו "קְדֻשַּׁת שַׁבָּת", — **With the help of Heaven, I have entitled this treatise "The Sanctity of Shabbat",** לִיקוּטֵי אֵיזֶה גִּרְגִּרִים פִּסְקֵי מַהֲעוֹלֶה בְּמַחֲשָׁבָה לְפָנַי בְּמֵילֵי דְּשַׁבַּתָּא, — **a gathering of a few gleanings, paragraph by paragraph, from that which arose in thought before me regarding the holy matters of Shabbat,** יוֹמָא דְּמָרֵי צָבֵי בֵּיהּ לְבָרְכוֹ וּלְקַדְּשׁוֹ: — **the day in which the Master of all willed to bless and sanctify:**

Weekday Labor Prepares the Sanctity of Shabbat

קְדֻשַּׁת הַשַּׁבָּת נִמְשָׁךְ מֵעֲבוֹדַת שֵׁשֶׁת יְמֵי הַמַּעֲשֶׂה, — **The sanctity of the Sabbath is drawn down from the active spiritual labor of the six working days,** כְּפִשְׁטֵיהּ דִּקְרָא בְּפָרָשַׁת יִתְרוֹ:[8] — **in accordance with the plain meaning of the scriptural text in Parashat Yitro (Exodus 20:9–10):** "שֵׁשֶׁת יָמִים תַּעֲבֹד וְעָשִׂיתָ כָּל מְלַאכְתֶּךָ, וְיוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי שַׁבָּת"; — **"'Six days shall you labor, and do all your work; but the seventh day is a Sabbath';"** וְכֵן בְּסוֹף פָּרָשַׁת תִּשָּׂא: "שֵׁשֶׁת יָמִים תַּעֲבֹד וּבַיּוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי תִּשְׁבֹּת";[9] — **and likewise at the end of Parashat Ki Tisa (Exodus 34:21): "'Six days shall you labor, and on the seventh day you shall rest';"** וּבְפָרָשַׁת מִשְׁפָּטִים: "שֵׁשֶׁת יָמִים תַּעֲשֶׂה מַעֲשֶׂיךָ וּבַיּוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי וְגוֹמֵר".[10, 11] — **and in Parashat Mishpatim (Exodus 23:12): "'Six days shall you do your work, and on the seventh day, etc.'"** (אֲבָל מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב בְּרֵאשׁ פָּרָשַׁת תִּשָּׂא (שְׁמוֹת ל״א:ט״ו):[12] "שֵׁשֶׁת יָמִים יֵעָשֶׂה מְלָאכָה וְגוֹמֵר", — **(However, regarding that which is written at the beginning of Parashat Ki Tisa (Exodus 31:15): "'Six days work shall be done, etc.,'** וְכֵן בְּרֵאשׁ פָּרָשַׁת וַיַּקְהֵל: "שֵׁשֶׁת יָמִים תֵּעָשֶׂה מְלָאכָה",[13] — **and similarly at the beginning of Parashat Vayakhel (Exodus 35:2): "'Six days shall work be done',"** שָׁם נִיחָא דְּקָאֵי אַמְּלָאכֶת הַמִּשְׁכָּן, — **in those places it is well understood, for the text there refers to the holy construction of the Tabernacle,** וְעַל כֵּן אָמַר לְשׁוֹן "יֵעָשֶׂה" וְ"תֵּעָשֶׂה" דְּמַשְׁמַע מֵעַצְמוֹ, — **and therefore Scripture employs the passive forms ye'aseh and te'aseh, implying that it was fashioned as if by itself,** וּכְמַאֲמַר רַבּוֹתֵינוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה עַל פָּסוּק "הוּקַם הַמִּשְׁכָּן", וְעַל פָּסוּק "וְהַבַּיִת בְּהִבָּנֹתוֹ".)[14, 15] — **in the spirit of the Sages' teaching on the passive verse 'the Tabernacle was erected' (Exodus 40:17), and 'the Temple, when it was in building' (I Kings 6:7).)**

וּלְאֵיזֶה צוֹרֶךְ פָּתַח הָא דְּשֵׁשֶׁת וְגוֹמֵר שֶׁאֵינוֹ אֶלָּא רִשּׁוּת, — **Now, for what purpose did Scripture open with the**

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[8] **Exodus 20:9-10**: ‘Six days you shall labor and do all your work, But the seventh day is a Sabbath unto the Lord your God: in it you shall not do any manner of work—you, nor your son, nor your daughter, your manservant, nor your maidservant, nor your cattle, nor your stranger that is within your gates.’

[9] **Exodus 34:21**: ‘Six days you shall work, but on the seventh day you shall cease from labor; you shall cease from labor even at plowing time and harvest time.’

[10] **Peri Tzadik, Mishpatim 6:1**: “But this is stated concerning Shabbat in the Sabbatical year because one might have thought that the essential commandment of Shabbat is for Israel to be free one day in seven for Torah and the service of God, blessed be He. During the working days, one turns to his olive grove and another to his vineyard, occupied with the affairs of this world; God, blessed be He, commanded them to rest from labor on Shabbat and be free for Torah. If so, in the Sabbatical year they had no such occupation throughout the year, since their principal work was working the land, and this was forbidden in the Sabbatical year. The poor and the rich were equal regarding the spontaneous growth, so the entire year was like Shabbat. Scripture therefore taught us that even in the seventh year the Shabbat of Creation is not displaced. Shabbat is similarly mentioned at the beginning of Ki Tisa and in Vayakhel, in the command to build the Tabernacle, to teach that its construction does not override Shabbat. One might have reasoned that, since throughout the week they were also occupied in causing the Divine Presence to dwell on earth, all the days were like Shabbat, and Shabbat would then be displaced. Scripture taught us that Shabbat is not overridden. For although being free for Torah and divine service is indeed part of Shabbat’s purpose, even when a person is free every day and occupied in Torah and divine service, Shabbat still has its own purpose: one merits holiness from God, blessed be He, which is fixed and enduring, as it is said, “To know that I am the Lord Who sanctifies you.””

[11] **Exodus 23:12**: ‘Six days you shall do your work, but on the seventh day you shall cease from labor, in order that your ox and your donkey may rest, and that your home-born slave and the stranger may be refreshed.’

[12] **Exodus 31:15**: ‘Six days shall work be done (ye'aseh melakhah—in the passive form); but on the seventh day is a Sabbath of solemn rest (shabbat shabbaton), holy to the Lord; whosoever does any work on the Sabbath day, he shall surely be put to death.’

[13] **Exodus 35:2**: ‘On six days work may be done, but on the seventh day you shall have a sabbath of complete rest, holy to GOD; whoever does any work on it shall be put to death.’

[14] **Exodus 40:17**: ‘And it came to pass in the first month in the second year, on the first day of the month, that the Tabernacle was reared up (hukam ha-mishkan—it stood up of itself through divine assistance).’

[15] **I Kings 6:7**: ‘When the House was built, only finished stones cut at the quarry were used, so that no hammer or ax or any iron tool was heard in the House while it was being built.’

clause regarding the six days, seeing that weekday labor is only an optional allowance, וַהֲוָה לֵיהּ לְמֵימַר רַק "בַּיּוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי וְגוֹמַר"? **— and it should rather have stated directly: 'On the seventh day you shall rest'?** אֶלָּא גַּם בְּטַעְמָא דִּיהֵיב לְפִי שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ קִדְּשׁוֹ אָמַר גַּם כֵּן: "כִּי שֵׁשֶׁת יָמִים עָשָׂה וְגוֹמֵר וַיָּנַח וְכוּ'לֵי עַל כֵּן בֵּרַךְ וְגוֹמֵר", **However, even in the rationale provided for Hashem sanctifying it, Scripture likewise states: "'For in six days Hashem made, etc., and rested on the seventh day; wherefore Hashem blessed, etc.'",** הִנֵּה דְּרַק עַל יְדֵי מַעֲשֶׂה בְּשִׁשֶּׁת יָמִים הַקּוֹדְמִים וְנָח בַּשְּׁבִיעִי, עַל יְדֵי זֶה בֵּרְכוֹ וְקִדְּשׁוֹ. **— showing that solely through active labor during the preceding six days and resting on the seventh did He bless and sanctify it.** וְכֵן אִיתָא בְּמַעֲשֵׂה בְרֵאשִׁית[16]: "וַיְבָרֶךְ וַיְקַדֵּשׁ וְגוֹמֵר כִּי בוֹ שָׁבַת וְגוֹמֵר", **— And so it is stated in the narrative of Creation (Genesis 2:3): "'And God blessed... and sanctified it, because in it He rested, etc.',"** דְּכָל קְדֻשָּׁתוֹ עַל יְדֵי שָׁבוֹ שָׁבַת מִמְּלָאכָה הַקּוֹדֶמֶת. **— demonstrating that its entire sanctity derives from resting on it from the prior creative labor.** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בִּשְׁאִלְתוֹת וְתַנְחוּמָא פָּרָשַׁת בְּרֵאשִׁית: **— And as written in the She'iltot of Rav Achai and Midrash Tanchuma, Parashat Bereishit (2):** כְּמַאן דְּבָנֵי בֵּיתָא וְגָמַר לַעֲבִידְתֵּיהּ וְעָבִיד יוֹם טוֹב, עַיֵּין שָׁם.[17] **— like a builder who constructs a house, finishes his work, and celebrates a festive banquet; see there.**

וְהָאָדָם נִבְרָא בַּדּוּגְמָא הָעֶלְיוֹנָה כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב: "נַעֲשֶׂה אָדָם בְּצַלְמֵנוּ כִּדְמוּתֵנוּ", **— And man was created modeled after the supernal Prototype, as it is written: 'Let us make man in our image, after our likeness',** וּמַה שֶּׁפָּעַל הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ בִּימֵי בְרֵאשִׁית הֵן דּוּגְמָא לִפְעֻלַּת הָאָדָם כָּל יְמֵי עוֹלָם; **— and that which Hashem, blessed be He, wrought during the days of Creation serves as the blueprint for man's spiritual action all the days of the world;** כִּי כָּל מַה שֶּׁבָּרָא הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא צָרִיךְ תִּיקּוּן, **— for everything the Holy One, blessed be He, created requires rectification and completion,** כְּמַאֲמַר רַבּוֹתֵינוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה בְּעִנְיַן הַמִּילָה[18] **— as our Sages of blessed memory expounded regarding the commandment of circumcision (Bereishit Rabbah 11:6),** שֶׁהֶרְאָה הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ שֶׁאֲפִילּוּ בְּרִיאַת גּוּף הָאָדָם לֹא נִשְׁלַם עַדַיִן בִּבְרִיאָה וְצָרִיךְ תִּיקּוּן עַל יְדֵי הָאָדָם.[19] **— wherein Hashem demonstrated that even the physical body of man was not brought to ultimate completion at birth, requiring human rectification.** וְעַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁאָמַר לֵיהּ רַבִּי עֲקִיבָא לְאוֹתוֹ מִין דְּמַעֲשֶׂה בְּנֵי אָדָם יָפִים יוֹתֵר, **— And in the manner that Rabbi Akiva replied to that philosopher (Turnus Rufus), that the works of human beings are more refined,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁהֶרְאָהוּ בַּחוּשׁ מִגְּלוּסְקָאוֹת וְחִטִּים.[20] **— as he tangibly demonstrated to him through the comparison of**

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[16] **Genesis 2:**3: 'And God blessed the seventh day, and sanctified it; because that in it He rested from all His work which God created to make (asher bara Elohim la'asot).'

[17] **Midrash Tanchuma, Bereshit 2:1**: "An inquiry: The house of Israel is obligated to rest on the day of Shabbat. When the Holy One, blessed be He, created His world, He created it in six days and rested on the day of Shabbat; He blessed and sanctified it, like one who built a house, completed his work, and made a festive day. Thus people speak of a celebration upon completing a house, as it is written: "God completed on the seventh day." The Merciful One says: Rest on the day of Shabbat, just as I rested on it, as it is written: "He rested on the seventh day; therefore the Lord blessed," and so forth."

[18] **Bereshit Rabbah 11:6**: "A certain philosopher once asked Rabbi Hoshaya, saying to him: 'If circumcision is so dear to Him God, why was it not given to Adam the first man?' He said to him: 'Why does this man the philosopher shave the corner of the hair on his head but leave the corner of his beard?' He replied: 'It is because this the head hair grew with him in his period of foolishness.' He said to him: 'If so, he should put out his eye, sever his hands, and break his legs, because they too grew with him in his period of foolishness.' He said to him: 'Have we come to such frivolous arguments?' This was a rhetorical question. He said to him: 'It is not possible for me to dismiss you with no response at all. The explanation is that everything that was created during the six days of Creation requires some action to bring it to its perfected state, e.g., mustard requires sweetening, lupines require sweetening, wheat requires grinding. And even man needs to be perfected.'"

[19] **Beit Yaakov on Torah, Lech Lecha 42:5**. To understand the matter: Why did Abraham our father not circumcise himself before God told him to do so, since he fulfilled the entire Torah, as stated in the Talmud? He was afraid to alter the limbs of his body, since this appeared to say that there was a deficiency at the root of creation and that it required correction. It would be like saying to a craftsman, "How ugly is this vessel you made!" Our holy forefathers stood continually before God, face to face. Therefore, he did not circumcise himself until he had an explicit divine command, through which God indicated that He had left this area for a person to exercise his own responsibility and rectify himself. Concerning this, Tanchuma states that human deeds are more beautiful than the deeds of the Holy One, blessed be He. God created the human being with freedom in his hand and the ability to extend himself as his heart desires; the person, for his part, restrains himself. Through this he can receive God's influence in a clarified form, and the offspring he produces will be an enduring structure from which the glory of Heaven will grow.

[20] **Midrash Tanchuma, Tazria 5**: 'Turnus Rufus the wicked asked Rabbi Akiva: "Whose works are more beautiful, those of the Holy One, blessed be He, or those of flesh and blood?" Rabbi Akiva replied: "Those of flesh and blood are more beautiful!" When Turnus Rufus challenged him over circumcision, Rabbi Akiva brought him stalks of wheat and fine baked cakes of bread, saying: "These stalks are the work of the Holy One, blessed be He, and these cakes are the work of flesh and blood—are not the cakes finer?" Turnus Rufus said: "If God desires circumcision, why does the infant not emerge circumcised from his mother's womb?" Rabbi Akiva answered: "Because the Holy One, blessed be He, gave

baked cakes versus raw stalks of wheat (Tanchuma, Tazria 5). כִּי עַל זֶה הָיָה תַּכְלִית בְּרִיאַת הָעוֹלָם וְהָאָדָם בְּתוֹכוֹ בְּצֶלֶם אֱלֹהִים — **For this was the very teleological purpose of the creation of the cosmos and man within it in the image of God:** לִהְיוֹת הוּא הַמַּשְׁלִים וּמְתַקֵּן כָּל הַבְּרִיאָה כֻּלָּהּ. — **that man be the finisher and rectifying agent of the entirety of Creation.**

וְזֶהוּ צַד צָפוֹן הַפָּתוּחַ כְּמַאֲמַר רַבּוֹתֵינוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה,[21] — **And this corresponds to the Northern Side being left open, as our Sages of blessed memory taught (Pirkei DeRabbi Eliezer 3),** וְשָׁם מִשְׁכַּן הַבְּחִירָה: — **and there is the dwelling place of human free choice:** "מִצָּפוֹן תִּפָּתַח הָרָעָה וְגוֹמֵר",[22] — **for those who do evil: 'Out of the north evil shall break forth, etc.' (Jeremiah 1:14),** וְלַבּוֹחֲרִים בַּטּוֹב: "מִצָּפוֹן זָהָב יֵאָתֶה" (אִיּוֹב ל״ז:כ״ב).[23] — **while for those choosing good: 'Out of the north comes golden splendor' (Job 37:22).** וְהוּא הָאוֹצָר שֶׁל יִרְאַת שָׁמַיִם שֶׁאֵין לוֹ לְהַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא בְּעוֹלָמוֹ אֶלָּא זֶה בִּלְבַד,[24] — **And this is the storehouse of the fear of Heaven, concerning which the Holy One has nothing else in His world (Berakhot 33b),** שֶׁזֶּה אֵינוֹ בִּגְזֵירָה רַק תָּלוּי בִּבְחִירַת אָדָם — **for this is not determined by decree, being dependent entirely on human choice,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב: "הַכֹּל בִּידֵי שָׁמַיִם חוּץ מִיִּרְאַת שָׁמָיִם". — **as it is written: 'Everything is in the hands of Heaven except the fear of Heaven.'** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "מָה ה' שֹׁאֵל מֵעִמָּךְ" דַּיְיקָא, "כִּי אִם לְיִרְאָה".[25] — **And as Scripture states: 'What does Hashem ask from you'—specifically from you—'but to fear' (Deuteronomy 10:12).** וְאָדָם לְעָמָל יוּלָּד;[26] — **And 'man is born to toil' (Job 5:7);** וְאַף בְּאָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן קוֹדֶם הַחֵטְא נֶאֱמַר: "וַיַּנִּחֵהוּ בְגַן עֵדֶן לְעָבְדָהּ וּלְשָׁמְרָהּ",[27] — **and even regarding Adam the First prior to the sin it was stated: 'And He placed him in the Garden of Eden to dress it and to keep it' (Genesis 2:15),** וְנֶאֱמַר: "וְאָדָם אַיִן לַעֲבֹד אֶת הָאֲדָמָה".[28] — **and Scripture states: 'and there was not a man to till the ground' (Genesis 2:5).** וְרַבּוֹתֵינוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה אָמְרוּ:

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the commandments to Israel solely in order to refine and purify them through their own action!"'

[21] **Pirkei DeRabbi Eliezer 3:11**: "Another interpretation: The northern side—He created it but did not finish it. He said: Whoever claims that he is a god should come and finish this corner that I left, and everyone will know that he is a god."

[22] **Jeremiah 1:14**: 'And the Lord said to me: Out of the north the evil shall break forth upon all the inhabitants of the land.'

[23] **Job 37:22**: 'By the north wind the golden rays emerge; The splendor about God is awesome.'

[24] **Berakhot 33b:23-25**: "Rabbi Chanina also said: Everything is in the hands of Heaven except the fear of Heaven, as it says, 'And now, Israel, what does Hashem your God ask of you, except to fear…' Is fear of Heaven a small matter? Rabbi Chanina said in the name of Rabbi Shimon ben Yochai: The Holy One, blessed be He, has nothing in His treasure house except a store of fear of Heaven, as it says, 'Fear of Hashem is His treasure.' Yes: For Moses it was a small matter. As Rabbi Chanina said: Consider a person who is asked for a large vessel and has it; it seems to him like a small vessel. If he is asked for a small vessel and does not have it, it seems to him like a large one."

[25] **Deuteronomy 10:**12: 'And now, O Israel, what does the ETERNAL your God demand of you? Only this: to revere the ETERNAL your God, to walk only in divine paths, to love and to serve the ETERNAL your God with all your heart and soul,'

[26] **Job 5:7**: 'For people are born to do mischief, Just as sparks fly upward.'

[27] **Genesis 2:15**: 'The ETERNAL God settled the Human in the garden of Eden, to till it and tend it.'

[28] **Genesis 2:5**: 'when no shrub of the field was yet on earth and no grasses of the field had yet sprouted, because the ETERNAL God had not sent rain upon the earth and there were no human beings to till the soil,'

בְּמִצְוֹת לֹא תַעֲשֶׂה. – "וּלְשָׁמְרָהּ" – בְּמִצְוֹת עֲשֵׂה, "לְעָבְדָהּ"[29] — **And our Sages expounded: 'to dress it'—through positive commandments, 'and to keep it'—through negative commandments (Pirkei DeRabbi Eliezer 12).**

The Toil of Torah Completes Creation

וְכֵן אִיתָא (בְּסַנְהֶדְרִין צט רֵישׁ עַמּוּד ב) עַל פָּסוּק "לְעָמָל יוּלָּד":[30] — **And so it is stated in Sanhedrin (99b) on the verse 'born to toil':** אֵינוֹ יוֹדֵעַ אִם לַעֲמַל פֶּה אִם לַעֲמַל מְלָאכָה וְכוּלֵי, — **one does not know whether he was born for the toil of the mouth or the toil of manual labor, etc.,** הֲוֵי אוֹמֵר: לַעֲמַל תּוֹרָה נִבְרָא. — **concluding: you must say he was created for the toil of Torah.** דְּזֶה הָיָה בְּרִיאַת הָאָדָם לְצֶלֶם אֱלֹהִים, — **For this constituted the creation of man in the image of God,** שֶׁהוּא הַשֵּׁם הַנִּזְכָּר בִּתְחִלַּת הַבְּרִיאָה: "בְּרֵאשִׁית בָּרָא אֱלֹהִים וְגוֹמֵר", — **which is the divine Name mentioned at the inception of Creation: 'In the beginning God (Elohim) created, etc.',** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה הוּא הַמַּשְׁלִימָהּ בַּעֲבוֹדָתוֹ. — **that man be the one who brings it to completion through his service.** וְכוּלְּהוּ גּוּפֵי דְּרוֹפְתֵּקֵי נִינְהוּ. — **And all human bodies are vessels formed to endure toil (Sanhedrin 99b).** רַק שֶׁיֵּשׁ שֶׁעֲמָלוֹ בְּדֶרֶךְ אֶרֶץ שֶׁקִּדְמָה לַתּוֹרָה, — **Only that there are those whose toil is in worldly vocation (derekh eretz), which preceded the Torah;** וּבְאוֹתָן שְׁנֵי אֲלָפִים תֹּהוּ שֶׁעַדַיִן לֹא נִתְּנָה תּוֹרָה נֶאֱמַר גַּם כֵּן: "לֹא תֹהוּ בְרָאָהּ לָשֶׁבֶת יְצָרָהּ"[31], — **and during those two thousand years of Tohu before the Torah was given, it was likewise**

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[29] **Pirkei DeRabbi Eliezer 12**: 'CHAPTER XII ADAM IN PARADISE 14A. ii. WITH love abounding did the Holy One, blessed be He, love the first man, inasmuch as He created him in a pure locality, in the place of the Temple, to form the first man from the four corners of the earth, establishing thereby the right of every human being to live and to be buried in any part of the earth. A similar idea was known to Philo, de Mundi opific. Mi. 35, C.W. i. p. 42, § 51. As to the Temple being the site of Adam's origin see T.J. Nazir vii. 2, 52b, and Gen. Rab. 14:8, and cf. infra, p. 143. Eden was more than a mere garden. See T.B. Berakhoth, 34b. and He brought him into His palace, as it is said, "And the Lord God took the man, and put him into the garden of Eden to dress it and to keep it" (Gen. 2:15). From which place did He take him? From the place of the Temple, and He brought him into His palace, which is Eden, as it is said, "And he put him into the garden of Eden to dress it" (ibid.). Perhaps thou wilt say: To plough (the fields) and cast out the stones from the ground. But did not all the trees grow up of their own accord? Perhaps thou wilt say: There was some other work (to be done) in the garden of Eden, (such as) to water the garden. But did not a river flow through and issue forth from Eden, and water the garden, as it is said, || "And a river went out of Eden to water the garden" (ibid. 10)? What then is the meaning of this expression: "to dress it and to keep it"? (The text) does not say "to dress it and to keep it" except (in the sense) of being occupied with the words of the Torah and keeping all its commandments, as it is said, "to keep the way of the tree of life" (ibid. iii. 24). But the "tree of life" signifies only the Torah,, ii. 24) and in the Slavonic Enoch xxxi. 1: "And I made a garden in Eden in the East, and (I ordained) that he should observe the Law and keep the instruction." as it is said, "It is a tree of life to them that lay hold upon it" (Prov. 3:18). And (Adam) was at his leisure in the garden of Eden, like one of the ministering angels.. lxii. The Holy One, blessed be He, said: I am alone in My world and this one (Adam) also is alone in his world. There is no propagation before Me and this one (Adam) has no propagation in his life; hereafter all the creatures, p. 79, we read that the animals wished to worship Adam, thinking he was their Maker. The belief was prevalent in former days that all the animals in Paradise were endowed with speech and reasoning power. See Jubilees iii. 28 (n. 28), and Grünbaum, op. cit. pp. 56, 60. will say: Since there was no propagation in his life, it is he who has created us. It is not good for man to be alone, as it is said, "And the Lord God said, It is not good for man to be alone; I will make him an help meet for him …" (Gen. 2:18). Rabbi Jehudah said:, 'meet for him,' but (read) l'negdo, 'against him.'" If he be worthy she shall be an help meet for him; if not, she shall be against him to fight him.'

[30] **Sanhedrin 99b:2**: "Rabbi Elazar said: Every person was created for toil, as it says, 'A person is born for toil.' I do not know whether he was created for the toil of the mouth or for the toil of labor. When Scripture says, 'His mouth presses him on,' you must say that he was created for the toil of the mouth. I still do not know whether this means the toil of Torah or the toil of conversation. When Scripture says, 'This book of Torah shall not depart from your mouth,' you must say that he was created for the toil of Torah. This is what Rava said: All bodies are vessels for labor. Fortunate is the one who merits becoming a vessel for the labor of Torah."

[31] **Isaiah 45:18**: 'For thus says the Lord, Creator of the heavens, who is God, who formed and made the earth and established it: He did not create it to be empty; He formed it to be inhabited. I am the Lord, and there is none else." Avodah Zarah 5a: "Reish Lakish said: Come, let us give thanks to our ancestors, for had they not sinned, we would not have come into the world, as it is said: 'I said: You are divine beings, all of you sons of the Most High.' You corrupted your deeds—'Indeed, you shall die like Adam.' Does this mean that, had they not sinned, they would not have had children? But it is written: 'And you, be fruitful and multiply'! That applied until Sinai. At Sinai too it is written: 'Go, say to them: Return to your tents'! That was for the joy of marital intimacy. But it is written: 'So that it may be good for them and for their children'! That refers to those children who were standing at Mount Sinai. But Reish Lakish said: What does 'This is the book of the generations of Adam' mean? Did Adam have a book? It teaches that the Holy One, blessed be He, showed Adam every generation and its interpreters, every generation and its sages, every generation and its leaders. When he reached Rabbi Akiva's generation, he rejoiced in his Torah and grieved over his death, saying: 'How precious to me are Your companions, O God.' Rabbi Yosei also said: The son of David will not come until all the souls in the treasury of souls are exhausted, as it is said: 'For the spirit would faint before Me, and the souls that I have made'! Do not say, 'We would not have come into the world,' but, 'We would have been as though we had not come into the world.' Does this mean that, had they not sinned, they would not have died? But the passages on levirate marriage and inheritance are written in the Torah! They were written conditionally. Can scriptural passages be written conditionally?

said: 'He created it not a waste, He formed it to be inhabited' (Isaiah 45:18), שֶׁיִּהְיוּ עוֹסְקִין עַל כָּל פָּנִים בִּיְשׁוּבוֹ שֶׁל עוֹלָם, **— that they should engage at the very least in the physical cultivation and maintenance of the world,** וְיִשְׁמְרוּ שֶׁבַע מִצְוֹת בְּנֵי נֹחַ, **— and observe the seven Noahide commandments,** וּבָזֶה הָיָה דַּי לְשָׁלֵימוּת אוֹתָן דּוֹרוֹת דְּשָׁנֵי תֹהוּ. **— and this was sufficient for the spiritual completion of those generations of Tohu.**

And as written in Bereishit Rabbah (39:8):[32] וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (בְּבְרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה לט): דְּבַאֲרָם הָיוּ אוֹכְלִין וְשׁוֹתִים, **— that in Aram they were eating, drinking, and acting frivolously,** אָמַר אַבְרָהָם: הַלְוַאי לֹא יְהֵא לִי חֵלֶק וּפוֹחֲזִין, **— whereupon Abraham said: Would that I have no portion in this land;** וּבָאָרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל רָאָה בָּאָרֶץ הַזֹּאת; **— yet when he entered the Land of Israel, he saw people actively engaged in weeding and hoeing,** עֲסוּקִין בְּנִיכּוּשׁ וְעִידּוּר, **— whereupon he said: Would that my portion be in this land!** אָמַר: הַלְוַאי יְהֵא חֶלְקִי בָּהּ. **— For this utilitarian maintenance was the purpose of the creation of the nations,** דְּעַל זֶה הָיָה בְּרִיאַת הָאוּמּוֹת, **— and Canaan in particular was destined as 'a servant of servants unto his brethren' (Genesis 9:25),** וּכְנַעַן בִּיְחוּד "עֶבֶד עֲבָדִים לְאֶחָיו"[33] **— to gather and amass so as to yield it unto one who is good before God (Ecclesiastes 2:26),** לָאֲסוֹף וְלִכְנוֹס לָתֵת לְטוֹב לִפְנֵי אֱלֹהִים,[34] **— referring to Abraham and his seed, the children of Israel,** זֶה אַבְרָהָם וְזַרְעוֹ בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל, **— who were born for sacred creative labor,** שֶׁהֵם נוֹלְדוּ לַעֲמֹל מְלָאכָה, **— as Ben Zoma proclaimed in Berakhot (58a):**[35] כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַר בֶּן זוֹמָא (בְּרָכוֹת נח.): כְּשֶׁעָמַד עַל

Yes, for Rabbi Shimon ben Lakish said: What does ‘There was evening and there was morning, the sixth day’ mean? It teaches that the Holy One, blessed be He, stipulated with the works of creation: If Israel accepts the Torah, well and good; if not, I shall return you to emptiness and void. They raised an objection: ‘If only their heart would remain this way’—it is impossible to remove the Angel of Death from them, for the decree has already been issued. Rather, Israel accepted the Torah so that no nation or language would rule over them, as it is said: ‘So that it may be good for them and for their children forever.’ Reish Lakish follows this other tanna, for it was taught: Rabbi Yosei says: Israel accepted the Torah so that the Angel of Death would have no dominion over them, as it is said: ‘I said: You are divine beings, all of you sons of the Most High.’ You corrupted your deeds—‘Indeed, you shall die like Adam.’ According to Rabbi Yosei too, it is written: ‘So that it may be good for them and for their children forever’; there would be benefit, but death would still exist! Rabbi Yosei answers: Since there would be no death, there could be no greater benefit than this.”’

[32] **Bereshit Rabbah 39:**8: ‘Rabbi Yehuda and Rabbi Neḥemya, Rabbi Yehuda says: “Go you lekh lekha” – twice,– go, go. one from Aram Naharayim and one from Aram Naḥor. Rabbi Neḥemya says: “Lekh lekha” – twice, one from Aram Naharayim and Aram Naḥor, and one when He flew him from the Covenant between the Pieces and brought him to Ḥaran. 1). He then returned to Ḥaran, and left again at age seventy-five, as recounted in our verse. That is what is written: “Your people amekha will volunteer on your day of battle ḥeilekha” (Psalms 110:3) – I was with you imekha when you volunteered on My behalf to descend into the fiery furnace. “On your day of battle” – when you assembled for Me all the hosts haḥayalot and masses. “In sacred glory hadrei” (Psalms 110:3) – from the radiance hadar of the world I sanctified you; “from the womb of the dawn mishḥar” (Psalms 110:3) – from the womb of the world I have sought you out sheḥartikha. “Yours is the dew of youth” (Psalms 110:3) – because our forefather Abraham was fearful, saying: ‘Perhaps I have a sin on my hands because I was an idol worshipper all those years?’ The Holy One blessed be He said to him: “The dew of your youth” – just as dew evaporates, so, too, your sins will evaporate; just as dew is a sign of blessing for the world, so, too, you are a sign of blessing for the world. That is what is written: “I said: Would that I had wings like a dove; I would fly away and come to rest” (Psalms 55:7). Why like a dove? Because all other birds, when they are weary, they rest on a stone or on a tree, but a dove, when it flies and grows weary, it folds one of its wings and flies with the other wing. “I would wander nedod far away” (Psalms 55:8) – movement after movement, wandering after wandering. is expounded as nidnud ¬– one wandering nod after another, from Ur of Chaldeans to Ḥaran and from Ḥaran to Canaan. “To repose in the wilderness, Selah” (Psalms 55:8) – it is preferable to repose in the wildernesses of the Land of Israel rather than to repose in the palaces outside the Land. And if you object that Abraham did not act immediately, and did not rejoice over the words of the Omnipresent, and you ask why did he not depart at once? It is because he had not yet been permitted, but once he was permitted: “Abram went as the Lord had spoken to him, and Lot went with him” (Genesis 12:4). Rabbi Levi said: When Abraham was traveling through Aram Naharayim and Aram Naḥor, he saw them eating, drinking, and reveling. He said: ‘Would that my portion not be in this land.’ When he reached the Promontory of Tyre, he saw them engaged in weeding at the time of weeding, hoeing at the time of hoeing, he said: ‘Would that my portion be in this land.’ The Holy One blessed be He said to him: “To your descendants I will give this land” (Genesis 12:7).’

[33] **Genesis 9:25**: ‘he said, “Cursed be Canaan; The lowest of slaves Shall he be to his brothers.”’

[34] **Ecclesiastes 2:26**: ‘For to the man who is good before Him, He gives wisdom, and knowledge, and joy; but to the sinner He gives the travail of gathering and heaping up, that he may give it to one who is good before God.’

[35] **Berakhot 58a:3-4**: “The Sages taught: One who sees a multitude of Israel says, ‘Blessed is the Knower of secrets,’ for their minds are not alike and their faces are not alike. Ben Zoma saw a multitude from a step on the Temple Mount and said, ‘Blessed is the Knower of secrets, and blessed is He who created all these to serve me.’ He used to say: How many labors the first Adam undertook before finding bread to eat! He plowed, sowed, reaped, gathered sheaves, threshed, winnowed, sorted, ground, sifted, kneaded, and baked, and only then ate. Yet I rise in the morning and find all these things prepared before me. And how many labors the first Adam undertook before finding clothing to wear! He sheared, washed, combed, spun, and wove, and only then found clothing to wear. Yet I rise in the morning and find all these

רְצוֹנוֹ לוֹמַר, כְּשֶׁרָאָה עַצְמוֹ מְעֻלֶּה גַּב מַעֲלֵה בְּהַר הַבַּיִת – **— when he stood upon the steps of the Temple Mount—** מַאוֹתָן הַנִּלְוִים, **— meaning, when he perceived himself as exalted in the camp of the Levites,** עַד שֶׁהִגִּיעַ לְמַדְרֵגָה שֶׁכָּל הָעוֹלָם כֻּלּוֹ לֹא נִבְרָא אֶלָּא בִּשְׁבִיל, **— among those who cleave directly unto Hashem,** אֶל ה', זֶה וּלְצַוּוֹת עָלָיו, **— having reached the spiritual level where the entire universe was created solely for this righteous one and to accompany him,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שָׁם (ס סוֹף עמוד ב), [36] **— as written there in Berakhot (6b end),** כִּי הוּא בְּתוֹרָתוֹ וּבַעֲבוֹדָתוֹ תִּקֵּן כָּל הָעוֹלָם כֻּלּוֹ, **— for he, through his Torah and divine service, rectified the entirety of the world;** עַל כֵּן אָמַר אָז: "בָּרוּךְ שֶׁבָּרָא כָּל אִלּוּ לְשַׁמְּשֵׁנִי, **— therefore did he pronounce: 'Blessed is He Who created all these to serve me,** כַּמָּה יְגִיעוֹת וְכוּ'". **— how much toil did Adam endure until he ate bread, etc.'**

דְּ"אִם אֵין, כִּי "אִם אֵין דֶּרֶךְ אֶרֶץ אֵין תּוֹרָה", [37] **— For 'if there is no derekh eretz there is no Torah' (Avot 3:17),** וְ"אִם יַחֲרוֹשׁ בְּשָׁעַת חֲרִישָׁה וְכוּ' תּוֹרָה מַה תְּהֵא, **and 'if there is no flour there is no Torah',** קֶמַח אֵין תּוֹרָה", **— yet if a person plows in the plowing season and reaps in the reaping season, what will become of the Torah?** אֲבָל כְּשֶׁיִּשְׂרָאֵל עוֹשִׂין רְצוֹנוֹ שֶׁל מָקוֹם, מְלַאכְתָּן נַעֲשֵׂית עַל יְדֵי אֲחֵרִים: [38] **— Rather, when Israel fulfills the will of the Omnipresent, their physical labor is executed by others (Berakhot 35b):** "וְעָמְדוּ זָרִים וְרָעוּ צֹאנְכֶם וְגוֹ'" (יְשַׁעְיָהוּ ס"א:ה'). [39] **— 'And strangers shall stand and feed your flocks, etc.' (Isaiah 61:5).** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שָׁם (לה:): [40] **— And as it is written there in Berakhot (35b):** "וְטוּבֵי לְדָנָיו וְהָנֵי דְּרוֹפְתְּקֵי לְהָיוֹת עֲמָלוֹ כָּל יָמָיו, **— "Happy is he who merits to be an enduring vessel for the toil of Torah,"** דְּאוֹרַיְיתָא", **— so that his continuous labor throughout all his days is in the toil of Torah;** וְהֵם בַּעֲלֵי תּוֹרָה, בַּעֲמַל תּוֹרָה, **— and these are the true masters of Torah,** שֶׁהֵם מַמָּשׁ הַדּוּגְמָא הָעֶלְיוֹנָה וְצֶלֶם אֱלֹהִים, **— who are literally the supernal reflection and the divine image,** דְּצוּרָתוֹ שֶׁל יַעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם חָקוּקָה בְּכִסֵּא הַכָּבוֹד, **— for the form of our father Jacob, peace be upon him, is engraved upon the Throne of Glory,** שֶׁהוּא מִדַּת הָאֱמֶת, **— which embodies the attribute of Truth,** וְאֵין אֱמֶת אֶלָּא תּוֹרָה. **— and there is no truth other than Torah.** וּמַאן דְּאָחִיד בְּאוֹרַיְיתָא אָחִיד בְּקוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא. **— And he who holds fast to the Torah holds fast to the Holy One, blessed be He.** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ בָּרָא הָעוֹלָם כֻּלּוֹ "בְּדָבַר ה'" וּ"בְּרוּחַ פִּיו" וּבַעֲשָׂרָה מַאֲמָרוֹת וְלֹא בְּעָמָל וִיגִיעָה, —

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things prepared before me. All the nations diligently come to the door of my house, while I rise and find all these things before me."

[36] **Berakhot 6b:35-36**: "What is the meaning of 'For this is the whole of man'? Rabbi Elazar said: The Holy One, blessed be He, said: The entire world was created only for this person. Rabbi Abba bar Kahana said: This person is equal in worth to the entire world. Rabbi Shimon ben Azzai says—and some say Rabbi Shimon ben Zoma says: The entire world was created only to provide companionship for this person."

[37] **Pirkei Avot 3:**17: 'Rabbi Elazar ben Azariah said: Where there is no Torah, there is no right conduct; where there is no right conduct, there is no Torah. Where there is no wisdom, there is no fear of God; where there is no fear of God, there is no wisdom. Where there is no understanding, there is no knowledge; where there is no knowledge, there is no understanding. Where there is no bread, there is no Torah; where there is no Torah, there is no bread. He used to say: one whose wisdom exceeds his deeds, to what may he be compared? To a tree whose branches are numerous but whose roots are few, so that when the wind comes, it uproots it and overturns it, as it is said, "He shall be like a bush in the desert, which does not sense the coming of good. It is set in the scorched places of the wilderness, in a barren land without inhabitant" (Jeremiah 17:6). But one whose deeds exceed his wisdom, to what may he be compared? To a tree whose branches are few but roots are many, so that even if all the winds in the world come and blow upon it, they cannot move it out of its place, as it is said, "He shall be like a tree planted by waters, sending forth its roots by a stream. It does not sense the coming of heat, its leaves are ever fresh. It has no care in a year of drought; it does not cease to yield fruit" (ibid, 17:8).'

[38] **Berakhot 35b:6-7**: "The Sages taught: What does 'You shall gather your grain' teach? Since it says, 'This book of Torah shall not depart from your mouth,' one might understand the words literally. Therefore it says, 'You shall gather your grain': combine Torah study with the ordinary conduct of worldly affairs. These are Rabbi Yishmael's words. Rabbi Shimon ben Yochai says: Can a person plow at plowing time, sow at sowing time, reap at reaping time, thresh at threshing time, and winnow when the wind blows? What will become of Torah? Rather, when Israel fulfills the will of the Omnipresent, their work is done by others, as it says, 'Strangers shall stand and tend your flocks,' and so forth. When Israel does not fulfill the will of the Omnipresent, they do their work themselves, as it says, 'You shall gather your grain.' Moreover, they also do the work of others, as it says, 'You shall serve your enemies,' and so forth."

[39] **Isaiah 61:**5: 'Strangers shall stand and pasture your flocks, Aliens shall be your plowers and vine-trimmers;'

[40] **Sanhedrin 99b:2**: "Rabbi Elazar said: Every person was created for toil, as it says, 'A person is born for toil.' I do not know whether he was created for the toil of the mouth or for the toil of labor. When Scripture says, 'His mouth presses him on,' you must say that he was created for the toil of the mouth. I still do not know whether this means the toil of Torah or the toil of conversation. When Scripture says, 'This book of Torah shall not depart from your mouth,' you must say that he was created for the toil of Torah. This is what Rava said: All bodies are vessels for labor. Fortunate is the one who merits becoming a vessel for the labor of Torah."

And just as Hashem created the entire world 'by the word of Hashem' and 'the breath of His mouth' through Ten Utterances without mortal exertion or fatigue, כֵּן הֵם מְקַיְּמִין הָעוֹלָם וּמַשְׁלִימִין אוֹתוֹ בְּרוּחַ פִּיהֶם, **— so too do they sustain the world and bring it to perfection through the breath of their mouth in Torah,** בַּתּוֹרָה, **— which is the master blueprint of the entire work of Creation,** שֶׁהוּא הַדְּפוּס שֶׁל כָּל מַעֲשֵׂה בְרֵאשִׁית, **— as written in Bereishit Rabbah, beginning of Parashah 1,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בִּבְרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה רֵישׁ פָּרָשָׁה א, **— and through meditating upon it is the absolute completion of the entire work of Creation achieved:** וְעַל יְדֵי הָעֵסֶק בָּהּ הוּא הַשְׁלָמַת כָּל מַעֲשֵׂה בְרֵאשִׁית:

And this is the first pillar among the three pillars upon which the world stands (Avot 1:2), וְזֶהוּ עַמּוּד הָרִאשׁוֹן מִשְּׁלֹשָׁה עַמּוּדִים שֶׁעֲלֵיהֶם הָעוֹלָם עוֹמֵד,[41] **— the greatest among them, the Pillar of Torah,** הַגָּדוֹל שֶׁבָּהֶם, עַמּוּד הַתּוֹרָה, **— which corresponds to our father Jacob, peace be upon him, whose name was called Israel after the Torah scholars who descend from him;** שֶׁכְּנֶגֶד יַעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם, שֶׁנִּקְרָא שְׁמוֹ יִשְׂרָאֵל עַל שֵׁם הַתַּלְמִידֵי חֲכָמִים הַיּוֹצְאִים מִמֶּנּוּ; **— for those three pillars correspond to the three categories of toil mentioned in Sanhedrin 99b on the verse 'born to toil':** דְּאוֹתָן שְׁלֹשָׁה עַמּוּדִים הֵם הַג' עֲמָלִים שֶׁנִּזְכְּרוּ בְּסַנְהֶדְרִין שָׁם עַל פָּסוּק "לְעָמָל יוּלָּד":[42] **— the toil of manual labor, the toil of speech, and the toil of Torah.** עֲמַל מְלָאכָה, וַעֲמַל שִׂיחָה, וַעֲמַל תּוֹרָה.

And certainly the intention of 'labor' is not the thirty-nine physical creative activities in the work of this world for mundane human needs, וּבְוַדַּאי אֵין הַכַּוָּנָה בִּ"מְלָאכָה" לִל"ט מְלָאכוֹת הַנִּשְׁמְיוֹת בִּמְלֶאכֶת עוֹלָם הַזֶּה לְצָרְכֵי הָאָדָם, **— for it could never enter the mind that for such physical toil was the ultimate purpose of man's creation in this world;** דְּלֹא יַעֲלֶה עַל דַּעַת דְּעַל זֶה הָיָה תַּכְלִית בְּרִיאַת אָדָם בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה, **— rather, only the creation of the idolaters and the Canaanite servants was designated for this mundane purpose,** וְרַק בְּרִיאַת הָעוֹבְדֵי כּוֹכָבִים וּמַזָּלוֹת וְהָעֲבָדִים כְּנַעֲנִים הָיוּ לְתַכְלִית זֶה, וּכְמוֹ שֶׁיִּהְיֶה לֶעָתִיד כ"ח מֵאוֹת מֵעוֹבְדֵי כּוֹכָבִים וּמַזָּלוֹת עֲבָדִים לְכָל אֶחָד מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל, כְּמַאֲמַר רַבּוֹתֵינוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה (שַׁבָּת לב:),[43] **— just as in the future there will be 2,800 servants from the nations for every single Jew, as our Sages taught (Shabbat 32b),** וְיִהְיֶה בָּהֶם הֶרְבּוּי כָּל כָּךְ כְּמוֹ שֶׁהוּא בְּבַעֲלֵי חַיִּים לְצוֹרֶךְ הָאָדָם, **— and their numbers will be plentiful like animals intended to serve human needs,** שֶׁיִּהְיוּ מוּכָנִים לַעֲשׂוֹת מְלַאכְתּוֹ וְכָל צָרְכָיו כְּדֵי שֶׁיִּהְיֶה לִבּוֹ פָּנוּי לְדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה. **— standing ready to perform his work and provide all his physical necessities so that his mind be free for words of Torah.**

And similarly that which is phrased 'for speech,' Heaven forbid that one should imagine it to refer to idle conversation, frivolous chatter to please the body, or mercantile negotiations, that such could ever be the teleological purpose of Creation! וְכֵן מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב "לְשִׂיחָה", חַס וְשָׁלוֹם לְהַעֲלוֹת עַל דַּעַת שֶׁיִּהְיֶה הַכַּוָּנָה לְשִׂיחָה בְּטֵלָה וְרִיבּוּי דְּבָרִים שֶׁל מַה בְּכָךְ לְעַגֵּג גּוּפוֹ אוֹ דִּבְרֵי מַשָּׂא וּמַתָּן וְכַדּוֹמֶה, שֶׁיִּהְיֶה לָזֶה תַּכְלִית הַבְּרִיאָה! וְעַיֵּין שָׁם בְּמַהֲרַשָּׁ"א וּבָרֵי"ף בְּעֵין יַעֲקֹב שְׁנִדְחֲקוּ בָּזֶה, וְהַמְעַיֵּין שָׁם יִרְאֶה מַה שֶּׁיֵּשׁ לְהָשִׁיב עַל דִּבְרֵיהֶם, וְאֵין לְהַאֲרִיךְ כָּאן:[44, 45] **— And see there in the**

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[41] **Pirkei Avot 1:2**: 'Shimon HaTzaddik was among the last members of the Men of the Great Assembly. He used to say: The world stands upon three things: upon Torah, upon the service of God, and upon acts of lovingkindness.'

[42] **Sanhedrin 99b:2**: "Rabbi Elazar said: Every person was created for toil, as it says, 'A person is born for toil.' I do not know whether he was created for the toil of the mouth or for the toil of labor. When Scripture says, 'His mouth presses him on,' you must say that he was created for the toil of the mouth. I still do not know whether this means the toil of Torah or the toil of conversation. When Scripture says, 'This book of Torah shall not depart from your mouth,' you must say that he was created for the toil of Torah. This is what Rava said: All bodies are vessels for labor. Fortunate is the one who merits becoming a vessel for the labor of Torah."

[43] **Shabbat 32b:6**: "Reish Lakish said: Whoever is careful about tzitzis merits having two thousand eight hundred servants serve him, as it says, 'Thus says Hashem of hosts: In those days ten men from all the languages of the nations will take hold of the corner of a Jewish man's garment, saying, 'Let us go with you.'"

[44] **Peri Tzadik, Kuntres Amalah shel Torah 2:1**. I believe that elsewhere I wrote (Kedushat Shabbat, discourse 1) that this "speech" means prayer: in Berakhot 26b, "Speech means only prayer." Since Rabbi Yochanan said there (21a), "If only a person would pray the entire day," one might have thought that this constitutes the whole purpose of a person. The teaching therefore says that the principal toil is the toil of Torah. As stated in Shabbat 11a, Torah scholars whose Torah study is their occupation, such as Rabbi Shimon bar Yochai and his companions, are exempt from prayer; and at the end of Rosh Hashanah, Rav Yehudah would review his learning every thirty days and pray only once in thirty days.

[45] **Beit Yaakov on Torah, Toldot 8:3**. The meaning is this: just as there are destructive forces within the creation of the world as a whole, so within the individual there are forces that seek to lead him into sin. At the creation of the world, the accusers said, "What is man, that You remember him?" (Psalms 8:5), and desired the world's destruction. Correspondingly, within the individual there is the power of the inclination that seeks to remove him from the world. When a person overcomes the inclination and breaks this destructive power, he also subdues the accusation above, until he makes himself like the Temple, with Hashem dwelling within him. This is what the holy Zohar says there: "The Temple below stands in the likeness of the Temple above." By making himself a Temple—that is, by subduing the evil force within him, so that Hashem dwells in him—all the accusers above are subdued, and the world is sweetened. This is

Maharsha and in the Rif in Ein Yaakov who were forced into strained interpretations on this; the discerning reader will perceive how their stances may be challenged, but there is no need to elaborate here:

Lovingkindness and the Work of Mitzvot

וְהַפָּשׁוּט לְדַעְתִּי, דְּהַכַּוָּנָה בַּ"עֲמַל מְלָאכָה" הַיְינוּ בְּמַעֲשֶׂה מִצְוֹת בַּפּוֹעַל בִּמְלָאכָת ה', — **And the straightforward meaning in my opinion is that 'the toil of labor' signifies the practical execution of mitzvot in the actual work of Hashem,** וּכְנִזְכָּר לְעֵיל עַל "לְעָבְדָהּ וּלְשָׁמְרָהּ" בְּמִצְוֹת עֲשֵׂה וְלֹא תַּעֲשֶׂה. — **as cited above on 'to dress it and to keep it' through positive and negative commandments.** וְזֶה הָעַמּוּד גְּמִילוּת חֲסָדִים שֶׁגַּם עָלָיו הָעוֹלָם עוֹמֵד, — **And this is the pillar of Lovingkindness (Gemillut Chasadim) upon which the world likewise stands,** בְּמַעֲשֶׂה מִצְוֹת בַּפּוֹעַל שֶׁעוֹשִׂים בַּעֲלֵי מִצְוֹת, — **in the practical performance of commandments fulfilled by the 'masters of mitzvot',** שֶׁעָתִיד הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא לַעֲשׂוֹת לָהֶם צֵל אֲצָל בַּעֲלֵי תוֹרָה, [46] — **for whom the Holy One, blessed be He, is**

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the teaching (Avot 2:4), "Nullify your will before His will, so that He will nullify the will of others before your will": the will of the accusers, the destructive forces. Prayer therefore needs to be in a house, that is, from a place of constriction: without spreading out into the benefits of this world, but held within limits for the honor of Heaven. It is like the shofar sounding from a narrow place (Zohar, Beshalach 60a), a vessel that confines the sound rather than letting it spread without measure. So too, all a person's prayers and desires must come from a place of constriction, without unbounded expansion. Our father Yitzchak was different: his distinguishing quality was sowing, and he surrendered himself entirely to Hashem. He saw explicitly that everything came from Hashem, and all his actions were directed toward the explicit manifestation of the honor of Heaven. He therefore prayed in the field, meaning that in every expansion of his activity he saw the honor of Heaven.

[46] **Kohelet Rabbah 7:11:1**: ""Wisdom is good with inheritance, and more so for viewers of the sun. For in the shadow of wisdom, in the shadow of money; the advantage of knowledge is that wisdom preserves the life of its possessors" (Ecclesiastes 7:11–12). "Wisdom is good with inheritance" – "wisdom is good" when it is an inheritance. Alternatively, "wisdom is good" when it is accompanied by inheritance, as we learned there in Avot (2:2): Torah study is best with a worldly occupation, etc. Alternatively, "wisdom is good" – the wisdom of Moses is good, as it is stated: "A wise man ascended against the city of the mighty" (Proverbs 21:22); "with inheritance" – as he bequeathed the Torah to Israel. Another matter, "wisdom is good" – this is the wisdom of Betzalel, who bequeathed the Ark to Israel. When Moses said to him: 'Craft an Ark, vessels, and the Tabernacle,' Betzalel said to him: 'Moses our master, does one bring the vessels and position them exposed to the air? Let the Tabernacle be crafted first and the Ark be crafted afterward.' Moses said to him: 'Were you, perhaps, sitting in the shadow of God and you knew? First, "they shall craft the Ark" (Exodus 25:10) and then, "the Tabernacle you shall craft" (Exodus 26:1)' – that is, "wisdom is good with inheritance," the wisdom of Betzalel is good, "with inheritance," as he bequeathed the Ark to Israel. Another matter, the wisdom of Joshua is good "with inheritance," as he bequeathed the land; "and more so for viewers of the sun." Alternatively, "wisdom is good" when it is accompanied by the merit of the forefathers. Happy is one for whom the merit of his forefathers stands and illuminates for him. Rabbi Aḥa said in the name of Rabbi Tanḥum: If a person studied, taught, observed, and performed the Torah's commandments, and he had the wherewithal to support, but he did not support, he is in the category of: "Cursed is one who will not uphold the matters of this Torah" (Deuteronomy 27:26). If a person studied, did not teach, did not observe, and did not perform, and he did not have the wherewithal to support, but he nonetheless supported, he is in the category of: "Blessed is one who will uphold," as every "cursed" indicates "blessed." Rabbi Huna said: The Holy One blessed be He is destined to provide shade and a canopy for those who have performed mitzvot with those who have studied Torah. What is the reason? "For in the shadow of wisdom, in the shadow of money." Three hundred nazirites ascended to sacrifice nine hundred offerings during the days of Shimon ben Shetaḥ. For one hundred and fifty of the nazirites, he found an extenuation, and for one hundred and fifty he did not find an extenuation. Shimon ben Shetaḥ went up to King Yannai and said to him: 'Three hundred nazirites ascended and they need to sacrifice nine hundred offerings, but they do not have the means to purchase them. You give half from yours and I will give half from mine, and they will go and sacrifice.' Yannai gave them half the required sum and they went and sacrificed. Someone went and spoke slander to King Yannai about Shimon ben Shetaḥ. He said to King Yannai: 'You should know that everything that they sacrificed was from yours, but Shimon ben Shetaḥ did not give anything from his.' King Yannai heard this and became angry at Shimon ben Shetaḥ, and Shimon ben Shetaḥ heard that King Yannai was angry and he fled. Some time later, there were important personages there from the kingdom of Persia, who were sitting at the table of King Yannai. After they ate, they said to Yannai, 'My lord the king, we recall that there was an elder here who would say words of Torah to us.' Yannai said to Salome, Shimon ben Shetaḥ's sister, who was King Yannai's wife: 'Send for him and bring him.' She said to him: 'Give me your word and send him your ring and he will come.' He gave her his word and Shimon ben Shetaḥ came. When he came, he sat between the king and the queen. Yannai said to him: 'Why did you flee?' He said to Yannai: 'I heard you were angry at me, and I was afraid of you. I fled so you would not execute me. I fulfilled this verse: "Hide for a brief moment until the wrath has passed"' (Isaiah 26:20). Yannai said to him: 'Why did you deceive me?' He said to Yannai: 'God forbid, I did not deceive you; rather, you gave from your property and I gave from my Torah, as it is written: "For in the shadow of wisdom, in the shadow of money."' Yannai said to him: 'Why did you sit between the king and the queen?' He said to Yannai: 'It is because it is written in the book of Ben Sira: "Extol it and it will exalt you, and it will seat you between leaders." Yannai said to him: 'Do you see that I honor you more than anyone?' He said to Yannai: 'It is not you who honor me, but rather my Torah honors me, as it is written: "Extol it and it will exalt you" (Proverbs 4:8).' Yannai said to them: 'Pour him a cup of wine so he can recite Grace after Meals.' Shimon ben Shetaḥ said: 'What will I recite? Shall I say: Blessed is He from whose food Yannai has eaten?' Yannai said: 'You remain in your stubbornness; I have never heard Yannai in the Grace after Meals.' Shimon ben Shetaḥ said: 'What, then, shall I say: Blessed that we ate? I have not eaten.' Yannai said to them: 'Bring him food so he will eat.' After having eaten,

destined to fashion a protective canopy beside the masters of Torah (Ecclesiastes Rabbah 7:12), כִּי הֵם גַּם כֵּן מְקַיְּימִין וּמַשְׁלִימִין הָעוֹלָם עַל יְדֵי עֲבוֹדַת וּשְׁמִירַת הַמִּצְוֹת בַּפּוֹעַל. **— for they too sustain and perfect the universe through the practical service and observance of the commandments.** וְהוּא הָעִמּוּד גְּמִילוּת חֲסָדִים שֶׁכּוֹלֵל כָּל הַמִּצְוֹת, **— And this is the pillar of Lovingkindness which encompasses all the commandments,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב: "גֹּמֵל נַפְשׁוֹ אִישׁ חָסֶד" (מִשְׁלֵי י״א:י״ז)[47], **— as it is written: 'The merciful man does good to his own soul' (Proverbs 11:17),** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (בְּשַׁבָּת לא א)[48]: "דַּעֲלָךְ סְנֵי לְחַבְרָךְ לָא תַּעֲבֵיד, זוֹ כָּל הַתּוֹרָה כֻּלָּהּ, וְאִידָךְ פֵּירוּשָׁהּ, זִיל גְּמוֹר", **— and as stated in Shabbat (31a): "'That which is hateful unto you, do not do to your fellow; this is the entire Torah, and the remainder is commentary, go and learn',"** וְעַיֵּין שָׁם בְּרַשִׁ"י, וְזֶהוּ גְּמִילוּת חֲסָדִים. **— and see there in Rashi; and this is the definition of Lovingkindness.** וּבַיְרוּשַׁלְמִי וּבְמִדְרָשׁ נִקְרָא בְּכָל מָקוֹם צְדָקָה בְּשֵׁם סְתָם "מִצְוָה", **— And in the Jerusalem Talmud and Midrashim, charity (tzedakah) is everywhere termed simply 'the Mitzvah',** וְנִרְאֶה כִּי הִיא כּוֹלֶלֶת הַכֹּל, **— and it appears that it encompasses everything;** כִּי קִיּוּם הָעוֹלָם עַל יְדֵי מַעֲשֵׂה הַמִּצְוֹת צָרִיךְ לִתְרַי"ג מִצְווֹת הַתּוֹרָה כֻּלָּם, **— for the maintenance of the world through fulfilling the mitzvot requires all 613 commandments of the Torah,** כִּי בְּכָל מִצְוָה יֵשׁ קִיּוּם

Shimon ben Shetaḥ recited the Grace after Meals and said: ‘From whose food we have eaten.’ Rabbi Yoḥanan said: The colleagues of Shimon ben Shetaḥ disagree with him. Rabbi Avin said: Regarding the second. Rabbi Yirmeya said: Regarding the first. They reversed the opinion of Rabbi Yirmeya, as there it is clear for him, while here it requires resolution. Alternatively, there, it is clear for him, in accordance with the opinion of Rabban Shimon ben Gamliel, while here it requires resolution, according to the Rabbis, as it is taught in this regard: If one reclined and dipped with them, even though he did not eat with them an olive-bulk of grain, they include him in their zimmun; this is the statement of the Rabbis. Rabbi Yaakov bar Aḥa said in the name of Rabbi Isi: Actually, one does not include him in the zimun unless he eats an olive-bulk of grain. It is taught: Two who ate grain and one who ate something other than grain join together. In accordance with whose opinion is this taught? It is in accordance with the opinion of Rabban Shimon ben Gamliel. There were three prominent wealthy leaders in Jerusalem: Ben Tzitzit HaKesat, Nakdimon ben Guryon, and ben Kalba Savua. Each and every one of them was capable of providing for and sustaining the country for ten years. There was a warrior there named ben-Batiaḥ, the son of Rabbi Yoḥanan ben Zakkai’s sister, who was the official in charge of the storehouses, and the leader of the rebels in Jerusalem. He arose and burned the storehouses. Rabbi Yoḥanan ben Zakkai heard and said: ‘Alas.’ They went and told ben-Batiaḥ that his uncle had said: ‘Alas, alas.’ He sent and had him brought and said to him: ‘Why did you say alas?’ Rabbi Yoḥanan said to him: ‘I did not say alas vai, but I said hurrah vah, for as long as the full storehouses are intact, they will not give their lives to wage war.’ By the difference between vai and vah, Rabbi Yoḥanan was spared. They read in his regard: “The advantage of knowledge is that wisdom preserves the life of its possessors.” There was an incident involving Rabbi Yoḥanan, who was overcome with bulmus, and he went to Emmaus. He sat to the east of a fig tree and was cured. They said to him: ‘From where did you know that figs could cure you of this condition?’ He said to them: ‘From David, as it is written: “They gave him a slice of pressed figs”’ (I Samuel 30:12). They read in his regard: “The advantage of knowledge is that wisdom preserves the life of its possessors.” Rabbi Yosei bar Yasin was traveling on a ship coming from Tarshish. His lad said to him: ‘I need to descend.’ Rabbi Yosei said to him: ‘Do not descend into the sea, as the sea is dangerous.’ The lad said to him: ‘I must recite shema.’ He said to the lad: ‘Recite it.’ The lad said to him: ‘I need to eat.’ He said to the lad: ‘Eat.’ When they came to port, he said to the lad: It is prohibited for you until you immerse. It was read in his regard: “The advantage of knowledge is that wisdom preserves the life of its possessors.” Rabbi Meir was wanted by the government, and he fled. He passed an Aramean inn and found them sitting and partaking of “that species.” They saw him and said: ‘It is him, it is not him.’ They said: ‘To see if it is him, let us invite him and see if he comes to eat with us.’ Rabbi Meir dipped one of his fingers into the pig’s blood and put a different finger into his mouth; he dipped this one and sucked that one. The Romans thought he had eaten the pig blood and said to each other: ‘Were he Rabbi Meir, he would not have done so.’ They let him be, and he fled. It was read in his regard: “The advantage of knowledge is that wisdom preserves the life of its possessors.” Rabbi Yehuda HaNasi was dying in Tzippori, and the residents of Tzippori said: ‘Anyone who comes and says that Rabbi died, we will kill him.’ Bar Kappara went to the window and looked outside, and his head was covered and his garments were rent. He said: ‘Our brethren, descendants of Yedaya, hear me, hear me. Angels and righteous people grasped the Tablets of the covenant. Angels overcame the righteous, and they snatched the Tablets.’ They said to him: ‘Has Rabbi died?’ He said to them: ‘You said so, I did not say so.’ Why did he not say? Because it is written: “One who utters a negative report is a fool” (Proverbs 10:18). They rent their garments until the sound of the rending reached Gufteta, at a distance of three mil. It was read in his regard: “The advantage of knowledge is that wisdom preserves the life of its possessors.” Rabbi Neḥemya said in the name of Rabbi Mana: Miraculous acts were performed on that day. It was Friday and all the cities gathered for Rabbi’s eulogy. They stopped his burial procession to eulogize him at eighteen synagogues, and took him to Beit She’arim, and the day lasted until each and every one of the people of Israel reached home and kindled a lamp for himself, roasted a fish for himself, and filled a barrel of water for himself, until the last of them did so; then the sun set and the rooster crowed. The people began to become agitated and said: ‘Alas, we have desecrated Shabbat!’ A Divine Voice called out and said: ‘Anyone who was not indolent in the eulogy of Rabbi is destined for life in the World to Come except for the launderer, who was there, but did not come.’ When the launderer heard this, he ascended and cast himself from the roof, and he fell and died. A Divine Voice called out and said: ‘Even the launderer who was on the roof is destined for life in the World to Come.’”

[47] **Proverbs 11:17**: ‘A man of kindness benefits his own soul, but a cruel man troubles his own flesh.’

[48] **Shabbat 31a:6**: “Another incident concerned a gentile who came before Shammai and said: Convert me on condition that you teach me the entire Torah while I stand on one foot. Shammai pushed him away with the builder’s measuring rod in his hand. He came before Hillel, who converted him. Hillel said to him: What is hateful to you, do not do to your fellow. This is the entire Torah; the rest is its explanation. Go and learn.”

לִנְבָרְאִים פְּרָטִיִּים, — **for within each specific commandment resides the spiritual sustaining force for distinct creations:** כְּמוֹ דֶּרֶךְ מָשָׁל, עַל יְדֵי הַשְׁחִיטָה – תִּיקּוּן הַבַּעֲלֵי חַיִּים, — **such as, by way of example, through kosher ritual slaughter comes the elevation of the animal kingdom,** וְעַל יְדֵי הַמִּצְוּוֹת שֶׁבַּתְּבוּאָה – תִּיקּוּן הַצּוֹמֵחַ, — **and through the agricultural commandments tied to produce comes the rectification of the plant kingdom, and the like.** וְכַיָּדוּעַ כִּי הַמִּסְפָּר תַּרְי"ג הֵם נֶגֶד רְמַ"ח אֵבָרִים וּשְׁסָ"ה גִּידִים שֶׁבָּאָדָם לְתַקֵּן בָּהֶם קוֹמַת גּוּפוֹ וְנַפְשׁוֹ. — **And as is well known, the number 613 corresponds to the 248 limbs and 365 sinews of man, to rectify through them the stature of his physical body and soul.** וְהָאָדָם הוּא עוֹלָם קָטָן, — **And man is a microcosm (olam katan),** וּמִסְתָּמָא כֵּן הוּא גַּם כֵּן בָּעוֹלָם הַגָּדוֹל שֶׁהוּא דּוּגְמָתוֹ מַמָּשׁ, — **and naturally so it is likewise within the macrocosm of the universe, which directly mirrors him,** וְעַל יְדֵיהֶם נִתְקַן חֶלְקֵי הָעוֹלָם כֻּלָּם; — **and through these mitzvot all sectors of the cosmos are rectified;** וְאָפְשָׁר לְתַקֵּן הַכֹּל בְּמִצְוַת הַצְּדָקָה לְבַדָּהּ, — **yet it is possible to rectify everything through the single mitzvah of charity alone,** שֶׁאָמְרוּ (בָּבָא בַּתְרָא יא א):[49] "הַמְקַיֵּים נֶפֶשׁ אַחַת מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל כְּאִילּוּ קִיֵּים עוֹלָם מָלֵא", — **concerning which they said in Bava Batra (11a): 'Whoever preserves a single Jewish soul, it is as though he preserved an entire world',** וּבְקִיּוּם עוֹלָם קָטָן, אִם זָכָה לְבָנֵי אָדָם מְהוּגָנִים, הֲרֵי הוּא כְּמְקַיֵּים עַל יְדֵי זֶה הָעוֹלָם הַגָּדוֹל כֻּלּוֹ; — **and by sustaining this microcosm, if he supports worthy individuals, he is considered as sustaining through this the entire macrocosm;** אֶלָּא שֶׁעַל יְדֵי כָּל הַמִּצְוֹת הוּא בְּפַרְטוּת וּבְפוֹעַל בָּעוֹלָם כֻּלּוֹ, וְעַל יְדֵי הַצְּדָקָה הוּא רַק בִּכְלָל וּכְאִילּוּ. — **only that through the full range of mitzvot the rectification operates in specific detail and in actuality throughout the entire cosmos, whereas through charity it functions comprehensively and 'as though'.** וּמִכָּל מָקוֹם הֲרֵי הִיא דֶּרֶךְ כְּלָל שְׁקוּלָה לְמִצְוֹת כֻּלָּם בִּפְרָט, לִהְיוֹת נִקְרָא מִצְוָה סְתָם. — **Nevertheless, in a general way it is equivalent to all individual commandments combined, meriting to be titled simply 'the Mitzvah'.** וְכֵן לִגְמִילוּת חֲסָדִים הַגְּדוֹלָה מִצְּדָקָה כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (בְּסוּכָּה מ״ט ב)[50], — **And so too regarding deeds of Lovingkindness, which are greater than charity as written in Sukkah (49b);** וְגַם הַצְּדָקָה נִקְרֵאת גְּמִילוּת חֲסָדִים כִּי אֵינָהּ מִשְׁתַּלֶּמֶת אֶלָּא לְפִי חֶסֶד שֶׁבָּהּ כִּדְאִיתָא שָׁם. — **and charity is likewise subsumed under lovingkindness, for it is rewarded solely in proportion to the kindness invested in it, as brought there.**

כִּי הוּא מִצְוָה סְתָם, וְעוֹד טַעַם שֶׁנִּקְרָא מִצְוָה סְתָם, — **And an additional reason why it is termed simply 'the Mitzvah'** כִּי אֲפִילּוּ פּוֹשְׁעֵי הַמְּצוּיָה בְּכָל יִשְׂרָאֵל: — **is that it is a commandment found universally within all of Israel:** יִשְׂרָאֵל שֶׁאָמְרוּ דִּמְלֵאִים מִצְוֹת כְּרִמּוֹן, הַיְנוּ בְּמִצְוַת הַצְּדָקָה וּגְמִילוּת חֲסָדִים בְּפָרָט;[51] — **for even the transgressors of Israel, concerning whom it was stated that they are full of mitzvot like a pomegranate (Eruvin 19a), it is specifically in the mitzvah of charity and lovingkindness;** דְּבָזֶה, אֲפִילּוּ פּוֹשְׁעֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּגוּפָן, קַרְקַפְתָּא דְּלָא מַנַּח תְּפִלִּין,[52] — **for in this, even the transgressors of Israel with their bodies, the head that never donned tefillin (Rosh Hashanah 17a),** וּשְׁאָר רִשְׁעֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל הַיּוֹתֵר גְּדוֹלִים שֶׁאֵין בָּהּ שׁוּם לַחְלוּחִית שֶׁל מִצְוָה, — **and the most degenerate sinners of Israel who seemingly possess not a moisture of any mitzvah,** גַּם מִכָּל מָקוֹם הֵם מְלֵאִים

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[49] **Bava Batra 11a:2**: "It was taught: Binyamin the righteous was in charge of the charity fund. During a drought, a woman once came before him and said, 'Rabbi, support me.' He answered, 'By the Temple service, there is nothing in the charity fund.' She said, 'Rabbi, unless you support me, a woman and her seven children will die.' He arose and supported her from his own resources. Some time later he became ill and was close to death. The ministering angels said before the Holy One, blessed be He, 'Master of the universe, You said that whoever preserves one soul of Israel is as though he preserved an entire world. Shall Binyamin the righteous, who kept a woman and her seven children alive, die after so few years?' His sentence was immediately torn up. It was taught: Twenty-two years were added to his life."

[50] **Sukkah 49b:9-11**: "Rabbi Elazar said: One who gives charity is greater than all the offerings, as it is stated: 'To do charity and justice is more choice to the Lord than sacrifice' (Proverbs 21:3). Rabbi Elazar also said: Acts of kindness are greater than charity, as it is stated: 'Sow for yourselves according to charity, and reap according to kindness' (Hosea 10:12). If a person sows, it is uncertain whether he will eat or not; if a person reaps, he will certainly eat. Rabbi Elazar also said: Charity is rewarded only according to the kindness within it, as it is stated: 'Sow for yourselves according to charity, and reap according to kindness.' The Rabbis taught: In three respects, acts of kindness are greater than charity. Charity is performed with one's money; acts of kindness are performed both with one's body and with one's money. Charity is for the poor; acts of kindness are both for the poor and for the rich. Charity is for the living; acts of kindness are both for the living and for the dead."

[51] **Eruvin 19a:8-9**: "This also appears reasonable, for otherwise Reish Lakish would contradict himself. Reish Lakish said: The fire of Gehenna has no power over the sinners of Israel; this follows by an inference from the golden altar. The golden altar had a covering of gold only as thick as a dinar, yet it stood for many years and the fire did not overpower it. How much more does this apply to the sinners of Israel, who are full of commandments like a pomegranate! For it is said, 'Your temple is like a slice of pomegranate' (Song of Songs 6:7), and Rabbi Shimon ben Lakish said: Do not read 'your temple,' rakkatekh, but 'your empty ones,' reikatekh: Even the empty ones among you are full of commandments like a pomegranate."

[52] **Rosh Hashanah 17a:10**: "What are those of Israel who sin with their bodies? Rav said: A head that does not put on tefillin. Concerning those among the nations who sin with their bodies, Rav said: Through sexual transgression."

כֵּן בְּמִצַּוֹת הַצְּדָקָה וּגְמִילוּת חֲסָדִים שֶׁיֶּשְׁנוֹ בְּכָל זֶרַע יִשְׂרָאֵל, — **are nonetheless full of the mitzvah of charity and lovingkindness that permeates all seed of Israel,** שֶׁהֵם רַחְמָנִים וְגוֹמְלֵי חֲסָדִים כְּמַאֲמַר רַבּוֹתֵינוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה,[53] — **who are innately compassionate and bestowers of kindness, as in the teaching of our Sages (Yevamot 79a),** (יבמות דף עט ע"א) שֶׁכָּתוּב כְּמוֹ אִם לֹא אוֹתָן דְּמֻעָרָב רַב קָאָתוּ.[54] — **unless they descend from the Mixed Multitude (Erev Rav), as written in Beitzah (32b).** (ביצה דף לב ע"ב) וְעַל כֵּן לֹא יִדַּח מִמֶּנּוּ נִדָּח — **And therefore no banished one shall ever be lost from the seed of Israel:** אֲפִילּוּ מֵהַיּוֹתֵר גְּרוּעִים בְּתַכְלִית יֵשׁ בָּהֶם אֵיזֶה שׁוֹרֶשׁ טוֹב בְּהֶעְלֵם הַנֶּטוּעַ מֵאֲבוֹתָם, — **even among the absolute most degraded there remains a good root planted in hiddenness from their holy ancestors,** בְּהְיוֹתָם זֶרַע אַבְרָהָם יִצְחָק וְיַעֲקֹב, — **inasmuch as they are the seed of Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob,** שֶׁיָּצָא לַפּוֹעַל בְּאֵיזֶה מַעֲשֶׂה שֶׁל צְדָקָה אוֹ גְּמִילוּת חֲסָדִים שֶׁעָשָׂה מִיָּמָיו לְנֶפֶשׁ אַחַת מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל,[55] — **which was brought forth into reality through some deed of charity or kindness performed in his lifetime toward a single Jewish soul,** שֶׁהִזְמִין לוֹ הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ הַהָגוּן לְפִי עֶרְכּוֹ שֶׁיּוּכַל לְזַכּוֹת עַל יָדוֹ, — **which Hashem, blessed be He, arranged for him—a recipient fitting his measure through whom he could acquire merit,** לְהְיוֹת לוֹ עַל כָּל פָּנִים חֵלֶק מָה הַנִּשְׁאָר מִמֶּנּוּ לָעוֹלָם הַבָּא. — **so that there remain for him at the very least some enduring portion in the World to Come.** וְזֶהוּ עֶגֶד אַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם, שֶׁהוּא הָרִאשׁוֹן שֶׁהֵקִים עַמּוּד שֶׁל גְּמִילוּת חֲסָדִים בָּעוֹלָם, — **And this corresponds to our father Abraham, peace be upon him, who was the first to establish the pillar of Lovingkindness in the world,** וְהוּא הָאֶשֶׁל שֶׁנָּטַע בִּבְאֵר שָׁבַע, — **and this is the tamarisk tree (eshel) that he planted in Beer-sheba;** וְעַל כֵּן הוּא הָעוֹמֵד לְהַצִּיל כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל מִדִּינָהּ שֶׁל גֵּיהִנֹּם כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (עירובין יט.),[56] — **and therefore he stands at the entrance of Gehenna to save every Jew from its punishment, as written in Eruvin (19a),** וּמִשּׁוּם דִּמְלֵאִים מִצְוֹת כְּרִמּוֹן כִּדְאִיתָא שָׁם. — **and because they are full of mitzvot like a pomegranate, as brought there.** וְזֶהוּ עֲמַל מְלַאכְתָּם בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה הַנִּשְׁאָר קַיָּם לְעוֹלְמֵי עַד, — **And this is their toil of labor in this world which remains enduring forever,** שֶׁבַּעֲבוּרָם נוֹלְדוּ וְלֹא הָיְתָה יְצִירָתָם לְבַטָּלָה: — **for the sake of which they were born, so that their creation was not in vain:**

Prayer as the Service of the Heart

וַעֲמַל שִׂיחָה – אֵין שִׂיחָה אֶלָּא תְּפִלָּה, — **And regarding 'the toil of speech'—there is no speech (sichah) other**

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[53] **Yevamot 79a:3**: "David said: This nation has three distinguishing signs: They are compassionate, bashful, and performers of kindness. Compassionate, as it is written, 'He shall give you compassion, have compassion upon you, and multiply you.' Bashful, as it is written, 'So that His fear may be upon your faces.' Performers of kindness, as it is written, 'Because he shall command his children and his household,' to follow the Lord's way of righteousness and justice. Whoever possesses these three signs is fit to become attached to this nation."

[54] **Beitzah 32b:3-4**: "Rav Natan bar Abba said in the name of Rav: The wealthy people of Babylonia descend to Gehinnom. For example, Shabbatai bar Marinus came to Babylonia and asked them to provide him a business investment, but they would not give it to him. They would not even provide him food. He said: These people come from the mixed multitude. For it is written, 'He will grant you compassion and have compassion upon you.' Whoever has compassion upon other creatures is known to descend from our father Abraham; whoever does not have compassion upon other creatures is known not to descend from our father Abraham."

[55] **Divrei Soferim 21:1**. According to everyone, one who says, "This coin is for charity so that my son may live," and so forth, is fully righteous in this act, even though he intends his own benefit. As long as he intends a mitzvah, he has an effective intention even according to the view that mitzvot require intention; this suffices for him to be fully righteous in this act. Rosh Hashanah explains that this applies specifically to Israel; see Rashi there, who explains that their hearts are directed to Heaven. This follows Rambam's explanation of "He is compelled until he says, 'I am willing'": in the depths of his heart everyone wishes to obey the Sages, but the leaven in the dough obstructs him. Once he has been struck and the force of his inclination weakened until he also says aloud, "I am willing," that suffices. So too, a Jew's self-interested intention comes from the inclination that trains him to seek personal benefit in everything. But the depths of Israel's heart are directed solely to Heaven, as they say: "It is revealed and known that our will is to do Your will. What obstructs us? The leaven in the dough." When there is also an actual deed, this suffices to join with the will in the depths of the heart; the disturbing thought of the leaven in the dough is disregarded.

[56] **Eruvin 19a:8-10**: "This also appears reasonable, for otherwise Reish Lakish would contradict himself. Reish Lakish said: The fire of Gehenna has no power over the sinners of Israel; this follows by an inference from the golden altar. The golden altar had a covering of gold only as thick as a dinar, yet it stood for many years and the fire did not overpower it. How much more does this apply to the sinners of Israel, who are full of commandments like a pomegranate! For it is said, 'Your temple is like a slice of pomegranate' (Song of Songs 6:7), and Rabbi Shimon ben Lakish said: Do not read 'your temple,' rakkatekh, but 'your empty ones,' reikatekh: Even the empty ones among you are full of commandments like a pomegranate. But what, then, of the words 'Those who pass through the valley of weeping'? They refer to those who are liable to Gehenna at that time. Our father Abraham comes, brings them up, and receives them, except for an Israelite who had relations with a gentile woman: His foreskin is drawn over again, and Abraham does not recognize him."

than prayer, (בְּרָכוֹת כו:) כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב [57], — **as it is written in Berakhot (26b),** "לָשׂוּחַ בַּשָּׂדֶה" וְיָלְפִינַן מִקְרָא דְּיִצְחָק: (בְּרֵאשִׁית כ״ד:ס״ג)[58]. — **and we derive this from the verse concerning Isaac: 'to meditate (lasu'ach) in the field' (Genesis 24:63).** כִּי אַבְרָהָם הִתְחִיל בַּעֲמַל מְלָאכָה, שֶׁיָּגַע כָּל יָמָיו בַּעֲבוֹדַת הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ בַּפּוֹעַל מַמָּשׁ, — **For Abraham initiated the toil of manual labor, toiling all his days in the practical service of Hashem in actual physical deed,** וְכָל מַעֲשָׂיו וּפְעֻלּוֹתָיו כָּל יָמָיו הָיוּ רַק לַשָּׁמַיִם וּלְהַשְׁלִים עַל יְדֵי זֶה כָּל הָעוֹלָם כֻּלּוֹ; — **and all his deeds and initiatives throughout his lifetime were purely for Heaven, to bring to completion through this the entire world;** וְאַף תְּפִלָּתוֹ נִקְרֵאת שָׁם בִּלְשׁוֹן עֲמִידָה, שֶׁהוּא פְּעֻלַּת הַגּוּף. — **and even his prayer is designated by the terminology of physical standing (amidah), which is an action of the body.** אֲבָל שֶׁל יִצְחָק נִקְרֵאת שִׂיחָה, כִּי הוּא הַמַּתְחִיל בַּעֲמַל שִׂיחָה; — **However, that of Isaac is titled sichah (speech/outpouring), for he was the initiator of the toil of speech;** וְהוּא עַמּוּד הָעֲבוֹדָה, — **and this corresponds to the pillar of Divine Service (Avodah),** כְּמַאֲמַר רַבּוֹתֵינוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה (תַּעֲנִית ב.): [59] "עֲבוֹדָה שֶׁבַּלֵּב זוֹ תְּפִלָּה". — **as in the teaching of our Sages in Ta'anit (2a): "'Service of the heart'—this is prayer."** כִּי עִיקַּר עֲבוֹדַת הַתְּפִלָּה בַּלֵּב, — **For the essential service of prayer resides within the heart,** (בְּרָכוֹת לא.): כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב [60] דְּצָרִיךְ שֶׁיְּכַוֵּון לִבּוֹ וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁיְּעַבְּדוּ לַשָּׁמַיִם; — **as it is written in Berakhot (31a): that a person must direct his heart to Heaven;** הֵלֶב לְאָבִיו שֶׁבַּשָּׁמַיִם שֶׁבִּלְשׁוֹן הַמִּשְׁנָה (רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה פֶּרֶק ג מִשְׁנָה ח) [61]. — **and this is the subjugation of the heart to its Father in Heaven in the language of the Mishnah (Rosh Hashanah 3:8).** וְזֶהוּ הָעֲבוֹדָה שֶׁבַּלֵּב, דְּהָעִיקָּר לֵידַע לִפְנֵי מִי הוּא מִתְפַּלֵּל, וְשֶׁיִּהְיֶה כְּעוֹמֵד לִפְנֵי הַמֶּלֶךְ, כְּמַאֲמַר רַבּוֹתֵינוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה. [62] — **And this is the internal service of the heart: the paramount duty being to know before Whom one prays, standing as one situated directly before the King, as taught by our Sages.** וְזֶהוּ כִּוּוּן וְשִׁעְבּוּד הַלֵּב לַשָּׁמַיִם, — **And this is the focus and subjugation of the heart to Heaven,** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי זֶה שֶׁיִּרְאֶה עַצְמוֹ כְּאִילּוּ מֶלֶךְ גָּדוֹל עוֹמֵד עָלָיו, יַגִּיעַ אֲלָיו הַיִּרְאָה וְהַהַכְנָעָה בְּפַחַד הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ, — **wherein by picturing oneself as though an awesome King stands towering over him, awe and humble submission in the dread of Hashem overtake him,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּמוֹרָה נְבוּכִים, הוּבָא בְּהַגָּהַת

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[57] **Berakhot 26b:6**: "Isaac instituted the afternoon prayer, as it says, 'Isaac went out to converse in the field toward evening.' 'Conversation' means prayer, as it says, 'A prayer of the afflicted man when he grows faint and pours out his conversation before Hashem.'"

[58] **Genesis 24:63**: 'And Isaac went out walking uncertain; in contrast to others "to meditate." in the field toward evening and, looking up, he saw camels approaching.'

[59] **Taanit 2a:11**: "From where do we know that it is in prayer? For it was taught: 'To love Hashem your God and serve Him with all your heart.' What is service that takes place in the heart? You must say: This is prayer. And immediately afterward it is written, 'I will give the rain of your land at its proper time, the early rain and the late rain.'"

[60] **Berakhot 31a:17**: "The Rabbis taught: One who prays must direct his heart toward Heaven. Abba Shaul says: An indication of this is the verse, 'You prepare their heart; You cause Your ear to listen.'"

[61] **Mishnah Rosh Hashanah 3:8**: 'Incidental to the discussion of the required intent when sounding the shofar, the mishna cites the verse: "And it came to pass, when Moses held up his hand, that Israel prevailed; and when he let down his hand, Amalek prevailed" (Exodus 17:11). It may be asked: Did the hands of Moses make war when he raised them or break war when he lowered them? Rather, the verse comes to tell you that as long as the Jewish people turned their eyes upward and subjected their hearts to their Father in Heaven, they prevailed, but if not, they fell. Similarly, you can say: The verse states: "Make for yourself a fiery serpent, and set it upon a pole; and it shall come to pass, that everyone that is bitten, when he sees it, he shall live" (Numbers 21:8). Once again it may be asked: Did the serpent kill, or did the serpent preserve life? Rather, when the Jewish people turned their eyes upward and subjected their hearts to their Father in Heaven, they were healed, but if not, they rotted from their snakebites. Returning to its halakhic discussion, the mishna continues: A deaf-mute, an imbecile, or a minor who sounds the shofar cannot discharge the obligation on behalf of the community. This is the principle with regard to similar matters: Whoever is not obligated to do a certain matter cannot discharge the obligation on behalf of the community.'

[62] **Tzidkat HaTzadik 208:1**. The principal battle of a person against his inclination concerns the imaginings and thoughts in his heart and mind. Concerning this the Tikkunim say: "One who wins the battle is given the King's daughter"—this is prayer. Prayer is awareness of the One present before him, like standing before the King, as stated in Eruvin. This means the standing of the heart and mind, for God looks into the heart. If, Heaven forbid, an alien thought or an external reflection occurs to him, then at that moment he is not standing before Him. One who conquers his inclination and emerges from imagination and extraneous thought is granted this gift: God is present before his eyes during prayer. This is the joining of redemption to prayer, for redemption from Egypt means emerging from illusion, as explained above.

רֵישׁ אוֹרַח חַיִּים.[63] **— as written in the Moreh Nevukhim (Guide for the Perplexed III:52), cited in the Rema at the beginning of Shulchan Arukh Orach Chaim 1:1.** וְהוּא הַיִּרְאָה שֶׁגַּם כֵּן עִיקָרָהּ בַּלֵּב, **— And this is awe, whose foundational seat is likewise within the heart,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (יוֹמָא עב:) עַל פָּסוּק "וְלֵב אָיִן".[64] [65] **— as stated in Yoma (72b) on the verse 'and he has no heart' (Proverbs 17:16).** וְזֶהוּ דַּרְגָּא דְיִצְחָק דְּמְחַוֵי לְהוּ לְקוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא בְּעֵינַיְיהוּ כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (שַׁבָּת פט:)[66], **— And this is the spiritual rung of Isaac, who points out the Holy One before their eyes as written in Shabbat (89b),** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי הָרְאִיָּה בָּא לְיִרְאָה וּפַחַד יִצְחָק, **— for through inner vision one arrives at awe and the Dread of Isaac,** וְזוֹכֶה לַעֲבוֹדָה שֶׁבַּלֵּב זוֹ תְּפִלָּה. **— and merits this internal service of the heart, which is prayer.**

וְנִקְרֵאת שִׂיחָה לְגַבֵּי הַדִּבּוּר דְּדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה, **— And prayer is designated as mere 'speech' (sichah) relative to the transcendent Speech (dibbur) of Torah,** שֶׁזֶּהוּ עִיקַר הַדִּבּוּר: "דִּבְדְּבַר ה' שָׁמַיִם נַעֲשׂוּ",[67] **— for that is the quintessential Speech: 'By the word of Hashem the heavens were made' (Psalms 33:6),** שֶׁהוּא דִּבּוּר הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁהִיא הַכְּלִי אוּמָנוּת לִבְרִיאַת עוֹלָם, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּרֵישׁ בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה, **— which is the speech of the Torah serving as the divine instrument for creating the world, as written at the beginning of Bereishit Rabbah,** וְזֶהוּ הַדִּבּוּר דְּהַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא; **— and this is the transcendent Speech of the Holy One, blessed be He;** וְדִבּוּרִים דִּתְפִלָּה הֵם הַדִּבּוּרִים דִּכְנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל, מַה שֶּׁאִשָּׁה מְסַפֶּרֶת עִם בַּעְלָהּ, **— whereas the utterances of prayer are the expressions of the Congregation of Israel, comparable to a wife in intimate conversation with her husband,** וְזֶהוּ נִקְרָא שִׂיחָה, וְהִיא נוּקְבָא לְגַבֵּי הַדִּבּוּר דְּדִכּוּרָא. **— and this is termed sichah, occupying the feminine aspect (Nukva) relative to the masculine divine Speech (Dechura).** וּמִמַּה שֶׁכָּתוּב (סוֹטָה כח.)[68] לְדַיֵּק מִלְּשׁוֹן "מִשִּׂיחָתוֹ" וְלֹא "מִדְּבָרָיו", **— And from what is stated in Sukkah (28a) deducing from the phrasing 'from his sichah' rather than 'from his words':** דְּשִׂיחַת חוּלִין שֶׁל תַּלְמִידֵי חֲכָמִים צְרִיכָה לִמּוּד, **— that the mundane conversation (sichat chullin) of Torah scholars requires study,** לָמַדְנוּ דְּשִׂיחָה הַיְינוּ שִׂיחַת חוּלִין, **— we learn that sichah denotes ordinary dialogue;** וְנִקְרָא כֵּן דִּבּוּרֵי הַתְּפִלָּה לְגַבֵּי דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה, **— and the words of prayer are titled thus**

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[63] **Shulchan Arukh, Orach Chayim 1:**1: 'One should strengthen himself like a lion to get up in the morning to serve his creator. He should get up early enough to welcome in the dawn. And at least not after the Z'man Tefilah (time for praying) in which the congregation prays. Scripture says, "I placed Hashem before me always". This is a great concept in the Torah and is a paramount attribute for the Tzadikim (righteous people) who walk in the way of G-d. For the way in which a person sits, moves around, and carries out his daily activities while he is alone in his house is not the same way he should engage in these activities while standing before a great King. In addition, the way one speaks while amongst those in his home and the conversations he partakes with his relatives is not the same manner in which he would speak while in the presence of a mortal King. Surely when one considers in his mind that the mighty King, The Holy One blessed be his name, where the whole world is filled with his glory, stands before him and sees his deeds, as it states: "If a man will conceal his secrets and I will not see it, " states Hashem; immediately the fear and the proper awed train of thought of Hashem will descend upon him and he will always be embarrassed before G-d. And one should not be ashamed before people who mock his service to Hashem. Also, when one is in private and when one lies on his bed, he should know before whom he is lying and immediately his should arise with enthusiasm to serve his Creator and he will get up.'

[64] **Yoma 72b:11**: "Rabbi Shmuel bar Nachmani said in Rabbi Yonatan's name: What is the meaning of 'Why is there a price in the hand of a fool to acquire wisdom, when he has no heart'? Woe to the enemies of Torah scholars—a euphemism for the scholars themselves—who engage in Torah but have no fear of Heaven."

[65] **Proverbs 17:**16: 'What good is money in the hand of a fool To purchase wisdom, when that person has no mind?'

[66] **Shabbat 89b:5**: "Yitzchak further argues: How much have they sinned? How many years does a person live? Seventy. Deduct twenty, for which You do not punish them; fifty remain. Deduct twenty-five for the nights; twenty-five remain. Deduct twelve and a half for praying, eating, and attending to bodily needs; twelve and a half remain. If You bear all of them, well and good; if not, half shall be upon me and half upon You. If You say that all shall be upon me, I have already offered myself before You. Israel begin and say to Yitzchak, 'For you are our father.' Yitzchak tells them, 'Instead of praising me, praise the Holy One, blessed be He,' and points them toward the Holy One, blessed be He. Immediately they raise their eyes toward Heaven and say, 'You, Lord, are our Father; our Redeemer from of old is Your name.'"

[67] **Psalms 33:6**: 'By the word of the Lord the heavens were made, and all their host by the breath of His mouth.'

[68] **Sukkah 21b:8-9**: "Rabbi Shimon said: An incident involving Tavi, his slave. It was taught: Rabbi Shimon said: From Rabban Gamliel's conversation we learned two things: We learned that slaves are exempt from the sukkah, and we learned that one who sleeps beneath a bed has not fulfilled his obligation. Why not say, 'From Rabban Gamliel's words'? He teaches us something along the way, in accordance with what Rav Acha bar Adda said—and some say Rav Acha bar Adda said in the name of Rav Hamnuna in the name of Rav: From where do we know that even the conversation of Torah scholars requires study? For it says, 'And its leaf shall not wither.'"

relative to the divine words of Torah, כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר (שַׁבָּת י.) "מַנִּיחִין חַיֵּי עוֹלָם וְעוֹסְקִין בְּחַיֵּי שָׁעָה".[69] **— as stated in Shabbat (10a): 'They set aside eternal life and occupy themselves with temporal life.'**

וְאֵין הַכַּוָּנָה עַל צָרְכֵי בְּנֵי אָדָם שֶׁמִּתְפַּלְּלִים עֲלֵיהֶם שֶׁהֵם חַיֵּי שָׁעָה, וְכִדְפֵירֵשׁ רַשִׁ"י שָׁם, דְּאַיְנוֹ מַסְפִּיק מִשּׁוּם זֶה לְהַחְלִיט הַשֵּׁם "חַיֵּי שָׁעָה", דְּאַטוּ לֵיכָּא נַמֵּי בַּקָּשׁוֹת עַל חַיֵּי עוֹלָם, כְּבַקָּשַׁת הַחָכְמָה וְדַעַת וּתְשׁוּבָה וּסְלִיחָה שֶׁבְּגִ' רִאשׁוֹנוֹת דְּאֶמְצָעִיּוֹת וְכַדּוֹמֶה?! — **And the intention is not merely regarding the physical needs for which men pray being temporal, as Rashi commented there, for that reason alone does not suffice to designate prayer unequivocally as 'temporal life'; for is there not supplication in prayer for eternal life, such as requesting wisdom, spiritual knowledge, repentance, and forgiveness in the middle blessings of the Amidah, and the like?!**

וְכֵן תְּפִלַּת שַׁבָּת וְיוֹם טוֹב שֶׁאֵין בָּהֶם בַּקָּשַׁת חַיֵּי שָׁעָה כְּלָל! — **And so too the prayers of Shabbat and Yom Tov, which contain no requests for temporal physical sustenance at all!**

אֲבָל הַכַּוָּנָה עַל גּוּף פְּנִימִיּוּת הַחַיּוּת הַנִּמְשָׁךְ לָאָדָם מֵעֲבוֹדָה שֶׁבַּלֵּב זוֹ תְּפִלָּה הוּא חַיּוּת לְשָׁעָה – הַיְינוּ כָּל יְמֵי עוֹלָם הַזֶּה שֶׁהַבְּחִירָה מוֹשֶׁלֶת, דְּאָז עִיקַּר חַיּוּת הָאָדָם הַמּוּרְגָּשׁ בְּלִבּוֹ הוּא מֵהָעֲבוֹדָה שֶׁבַּלֵּב; אֲבָל לֶעָתִיד, שֶׁאָמְרוּ רַבּוֹתֵינוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה שֶׁיְּטַיֵּיל עִמָּהֶם בְּגַן עֵדֶן, וְ"לֹא יִכָּנֵף עוֹד מוֹרֶיךָ" (יְשַׁעְיָהוּ ל׳:כ׳),[70] — **namely, throughout the duration of this world where free choice holds sway, for in this realm the primary life-force felt within a person's heart derives from this emotional service; whereas in the ultimate future, when our Sages taught that the Holy One will stroll with the righteous in Eden and 'your Teacher shall not hide Himself any more',**

לֹא יִהְיֶה עוֹד הַמְשָׁכַת הַחַיּוּת מֵעֲבוֹדַת הַתְּפִלָּה שֶׁבַּלֵּב, רַק מִדִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה, שֶׁמִּמֶּנָּה הוּא הַמְשָׁכַת חַיֵּי עוֹלָם וּלְעוֹלְמֵי עוֹלָמִים כָּל הַחַיּוּת נִמְשָׁךְ רַק מִדִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה. — **the transmission of divine vitality will no longer proceed from prayer in the heart, but exclusively from words of Torah, which constitutes the influx of eternal life, and for eternity of eternities all life-force is drawn solely from Torah.**

Torah and the Inheritance of Jacob

וְזֶהוּ עִמּוּד הַתּוֹרָה הָעִיקָּר וְהַנִּבְחָר מִכֻּלָּם, דְּעַל כֵּן אָמַר שֶׁזֹּהוּ עִיקַּר הֶעָמָל שֶׁיִּהְיֶה לָאָדָם, שֶׁזָּכָה בּוֹ יַעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם, מוּבְחָר שֶׁבָּאָבוֹת, שֶׁהוּא עִיקַּר הַמְכֻוָּן שֶׁמִּמֶּנּוּ שְׁלֵימָה. כִּי אֵין שׁוּם שַׁיָּכוּת לְמִשְׁפָּחוֹת עוֹבְדֵי כּוֹכָבִים וּמַזָּלוֹת עִם דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה: "לֹא עָשָׂה כֵן לְכָל גּוֹי" (תְּהִלִּים קמ״ז:כ׳);[71] — **And this is the Pillar of Torah, the primary and most chosen of all, wherefore the Gemara declared that this is the quintessential toil for which man was created, merited by our father Jacob, peace be upon him, the choicest of the Patriarchs, who is the ultimate intended objective of Creation, whose bed was whole without blemish. For the pagan families of the earth possess no connection to words of Torah: 'He has not dealt so with any nation' (Psalms 147:20);**

מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן אַבְרָהָם וְיִצְחָק יָצָא פְּסוֹלֶת, כִּי יֵשׁ קְצָת אֲחִיזָה לָעוֹבְדֵי כּוֹכָבִים וּמַזָּלוֹת בְּשֶׂכֶל מְצוֹת בְּנֵי נֹחַ, וְכֵן בַּעֲשִׂיַּת צְדָקָה וָחֶסֶד לָעוֹבְדֵי כּוֹכָבִים וּמַזָּלוֹת, אַף דְּהוּא חַשָּׁאת לָהֶם וְנִקְרָא מִצְוֹת קַלּוֹת שֶׁהָיוּ מְקַבְּלִין שָׂכָר בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (בָּבָא בַּתְרָא י׃);[72] — **whereas from Abraham and Isaac dross emerged (Ishmael and Esau), because the nations possess a minor grasp in the seven Noahide commandments, and so too in performing charity and kindness, even though for them it is sin and termed 'light mitzvot' for which they receive reward in this world, as written in Bava Batra (10b);**

וְכֵן בִּתְפִלָּה נֶאֱמַר בִּתְפִלַּת שְׁלֹמֹה הַמֶּלֶךְ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם: "וְגַם אֶל הַנָּכְרִי וְגוֹמֵר

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[69] **Shabbat 10a:3**: "Rava saw Rav Hamnuna prolonging his prayer and said: They leave eternal life and occupy themselves with temporal life. Rav Hamnuna, however, held that prayer has its own time and Torah has its own time. Rabbi Yirmeya was sitting before Rabbi Zeira, and they were engaged in a teaching. It grew late for prayer, and Rabbi Yirmeya was hurrying. Rabbi Zeira applied to him the verse, 'One who turns his ear away from hearing Torah—even his prayer is an abomination.'"

[70] **Isaiah 30:20**: 'My Sovereign will provide for you meager bread and scant water. Then your Guide will no more be ignored, but your eyes will watch your Guide;'

[71] **Psalms 147:20**: 'He has not done so for any nation, and His judgments they have not known. Halleluyah.'

[72] **Bava Batra 10b:7-8**: "It was taught: Rabban Yochanan ben Zakkai said to his students, 'My sons, what does Scripture mean when it says, 'Righteousness exalts a nation, but the kindness of nations is sin' (Proverbs 14:34)?' Rabbi Eliezer answered: ''Righteousness exalts a nation' refers to Israel, as it is written, 'Who is like Your people Israel, one nation on earth?' (II Samuel 7:23). 'The kindness of nations is sin' means that all the charity and kindness performed by the idolatrous nations is a sin for them, because they do it only to advance themselves, as it is said, 'So that they may offer pleasing sacrifices to the God of heaven and pray for the life of the king and his sons' (Ezra 6:10).' But is charity performed in this way not complete charity? Was it not taught: One who says, 'This sela is for charity so that my sons may live, and so that I may merit the World to Come,' is completely righteous? There is no difficulty: This case concerns an Israelite, while that case concerns an idolater."